Matthew

Chapters

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THE GOSPEL ACCORDING TO MATTHEW

The Genealogy of Jesus Christ

1 The book of the genealogy of Jesus Christ, the son of David, the son of Abraham. *

2 Abraham was the father of Isaac, and Isaac the father of Jacob, and Jacob the father of Judah and his brothers, **3**and Judah the father of Per'ez and Ze'rah by Ta'mar, and Perez the father of Hezron, and Hezron the father of Ram, [a] **4**and Ram [a] the father of Ammin'adab, and Amminadab the father of Nahshon, and Nahshon the father of Salmon, **5**and Salmon the father of Boaz by Ra'hab, and Boaz the father of O'bed by Ruth, and Obed the father of Jesse, **6**and Jesse the father of David the king.

And David was the father of Solomon by the wife of Uri'ah, **7**and Solomon the father of Rehobo'am, and Rehoboam the father of Abi'jah, and Abijah the father of Asa, [b] **8**and Asa [b] the father of Jehosh'aphat, and Jehoshaphat the father of Jo'ram, and Joram the father of Uzzi'ah, **9**and Uzzi'ah the father of Jo'tham, and Jotham the father of A'haz, and Ahaz the father of Hezeki'ah, **10**and Hezeki'ah the father of Manas'seh, and Manasseh the father of Amos, [c] and Amos [c] the father of Josi'ah, **11**and Josi'ah the father of Jechoni'ah and his brothers, at the time of the deportation to Babylon.

12 And after the deportation to Babylon: Jechoni'ah was the father of She-al'ti-el, [d] and She-alti-el [d] the father of Zerub'babel, **13**and Zerub'babel the father of Abi'ud, and Abiud the father of Eli'akim, and Eliakim the father of A'zor, **14**and A'zor the father of Za'dok, and Zadok the father of A'chim, and Achim the father of Eli'ud, **15**and Eli'ud the father of Elea'zar, and Eleazar the father of Matthan, and Matthan the father of Jacob, **16**and Jacob the father of Joseph the husband of Mary, of whom Jesus was born, who is called Christ. *

17 So all the generations from Abraham to David were fourteen generations, and from David to the deportation to Babylon fourteen generations, and from the deportation to Babylon to the Christ fourteen generations.

The Birth of Jesus Christ

18 Now the birth of Jesus Christ [f] took place in this way. When his mother Mary had been betrothed to Joseph, before they came together she was

found to be with child of the Holy Spirit; [19]and her husband Joseph, being a
just man and unwilling to put her to shame, resolved to send her away
quietly. [20]But as he considered this, behold, an angel of the Lord appeared
to him in a dream, saying, “Joseph, son of David, do not fear to take Mary
your wife, for that which is conceived in her is of the Holy Spirit; [21]she will
bear a son, and you shall call his name Jesus, for he will save his people
from their sins.” [22]All this took place to fulfil what the Lord had spoken by
the prophet:

[23]“Behold, a virgin shall conceive and bear a son,
and his name shall be called Emmanuel”

(which means, God with us). [24]When Joseph woke from sleep, he did as
the angel of the Lord commanded him; he took his wife, [25]but knew her not
until she had borne a son; * and he called his name Jesus.

The Visit of the Wise Men

2 Now when Jesus was born in Bethlehem of Judea in the days of Herod
the king, behold, Wise Men from the East came to Jerusalem, saying,
[2]“Where is he who has been born king of the Jews? For we have seen his
star in the East, and have come to worship him.” [3]When Herod the king
heard this, he was troubled, and all Jerusalem with him; [4]and assembling all
the chief priests and scribes of the people, he inquired of them where the
Christ was to be born. [5]They told him, “In Bethlehem of Judea; for so it is
written by the prophet:

[6] ‘And you, O Bethlehem, in the land of Judah,
are by no means least among the rulers of Judah;
for from you shall come a ruler
who will govern my people Israel.' "

7 Then Herod summoned the Wise Men secretly and ascertained from
them what time the star appeared; [8]and he sent them to Bethlehem, saying,
“Go and search diligently for the child, and when you have found him bring
me word, that I too may come and worship him.” [9]When they had heard the
king they went their way; and behold, the star which they had seen in the
East went before them, till it came to rest over the place where the child
was. [10]When they saw the star, they rejoiced exceedingly with great joy;
[11]and going into the house they saw the child with Mary his mother, and
they fell down and worshiped him. Then, opening their treasures, they

offered him gifts, gold and frankincense and myrrh. [12]And being warned in a dream not to return to Herod, they departed to their own country by another way.

The Escape to Egypt

13 Now when they had departed, behold, an angel of the Lord appeared to Joseph in a dream and said, “Rise, take the child and his mother, and flee to Egypt, and remain there till I tell you; for Herod is about to search for the child, to destroy him.” **14**And he rose and took the child and his mother by night, and departed to Egypt, [15]and remained there until the death of Herod. This was to fulfil what the Lord had spoken by the prophet, “Out of Egypt have I called my son.”

16 Then Herod, when he saw that he had been tricked by the Wise Men, was in a furious rage, and he sent and killed all the male children in Bethlehem and in all that region who were two years old or under, according to the time which he had ascertained from the Wise Men. **17**Then was fulfilled what was spoken by the prophet Jeremiah:

[18]“A voice was heard in Ra'mah,
wailing and loud lamentation,
Rachel weeping for her children;
she refused to be consoled,
because they were no more.”

The Return from Egypt

[19] But when Herod died, behold, an angel of the Lord appeared in a dream to Joseph in Egypt, saying, **20**“Rise, take the child and his mother, and go to the land of Israel, for those who sought the child’s life are dead.” **21**And he rose and took the child and his mother, and went to the land of Israel. **22**But when he heard that Archela'us reigned over Judea in place of his father Herod, he was afraid to go there, and being warned in a dream he withdrew to the district of Galilee. [23]And he went and dwelt in a city called Nazareth, that what was spoken by the prophets might be fulfilled. “He shall be called a Nazarene.”

The Preaching of John the Baptist

3 In those days came John the Baptist, preaching in the wilderness of Judea, [2]“Repent, * for the kingdom of heaven is at hand.” [3]For this is he who was spoken of by the prophet Isaiah when he said,

"The voice of one crying in the wilderness:
Prepare the way of the Lord,
make his paths straight."

4 Now John wore a garment of camel's hair, and a leather belt around his
waist; and his food was locusts and wild honey. 5 Then went out to him
Jerusalem and all Judea and all the region about the Jordan, 6 and they were
baptized by him in the river Jordan, confessing their sins. *

7 But when he saw many of the Pharisees and Sad'ducees coming for
baptism, he said to them, "You brood of vipers! Who warned you to flee
from the wrath to come? 8 Bear fruit that befits repentance, 9 and do not
presume to say to yourselves, 'We have Abraham as our father'; for I tell
you, God is able from these stones to raise up children to Abraham. 10 Even
now the axe is laid to the root of the trees; every tree therefore that does not
bear good fruit is cut down and thrown into the fire.

11 "I baptize you with water for repentance, but he who is coming after
me is mightier than I, whose sandals I am not worthy to carry; he will
baptize you with the Holy Spirit and with fire. 12 His winnowing fork is in
his hand, and he will clear his threshing floor and gather his wheat into the
granary, but the chaff he will burn with unquenchable fire."

The Baptism of Jesus

13 Then Jesus came from Galilee to the Jordan to John, to be baptized by
him. 14 John would have prevented him, saying, "I need to be baptized by
you, and do you come to me?" 15 But Jesus answered him, "Let it be so
now; for thus it is fitting for us to fulfil all righteousness." Then he
consented. * 16 And when Jesus was baptized, he went up immediately from
the water, and behold, the heavens were opened [g] and he saw the Spirit of
God descending like a dove, and alighting on him; 17 and behold, a voice
from heaven, saying, "This is my beloved Son, [h] with whom I am well
pleased."

The Temptation of Jesus

4 Then Jesus was led up by the Spirit into the wilderness to be tempted
by the devil. 2 And he fasted forty days and forty nights, and afterward he
was hungry. 3 And the tempter came and said to him, "If you are the Son of
God, command these stones to become loaves of bread." 4 But he answered,
"It is written,

‘Man shall not live by bread alone,
but by every word that proceeds from the mouth of God.’ ”
[5]Then the devil took him to the holy city, and set him on the pinnacle of the temple, [6]and said to him, “If you are the Son of God, throw yourself down; for it is written,
‘He will give his angels charge of you,’
and
‘On their hands they will bear you up,
lest you strike your foot against a stone.' "
[7]Jesus said to him, “Again it is written, ‘You shall not tempt the Lord your God.' " [8]Again, the devil took him to a very high mountain, and showed him all the kingdoms of the world and the glory of them; [9]and he said to him, “All these I will give you, if you will fall down and worship me.” [10]Then Jesus said to him, “Begone, Satan! for it is written,
‘You shall worship the Lord your God
and him only shall you serve.' "
[11]Then the devil left him, and behold, angels came and ministered to him.

Jesus Begins Preaching in Galilee

12 Now when he heard that John had been arrested, he withdrew into Galilee; [13]and leaving Nazareth he went and dwelt in Caper'na-um by the sea, in the territory of Zeb'ulun and Naph'tali, [14]that what was spoken by the prophet Isaiah might be fulfilled:
[15]“The land of Zeb'ulun and the land of Naph'tali,
toward the sea, across the Jordan,
Galilee of the Gentiles—
[16]the people who sat in darkness
have seen a great light,
and for those who sat in the region and shadow of death
light has dawned.”
[17]From that time Jesus began to preach, saying, “Repent, for the kingdom of heaven is at hand.”

Jesus Calls the First Disciples

18 As he walked by the Sea of Galilee, he saw two brothers, Simon who is called Peter and Andrew his brother, casting a net into the sea; for they were fishermen. [19]And he said to them, “Follow me, and I will make you fishers

of men.” [20]Immediately they left their nets and followed him. [21]And going on from there he saw two other brothers, James the son of Zeb'edee and John his brother, in the boat with Zebedee their father, mending their nets, and he called them. [22]Immediately they left the boat and their father, and followed him.

Jesus Ministers to Crowds of people

23 And he went about all Galilee, teaching in their synagogues and preaching the gospel of the kingdom and healing every disease and every infirmity among the people. [24]So his fame spread throughout all Syria, and they brought him all the sick, those afflicted with various diseases and pains, demoniacs, epileptics, and paralytics, and he healed them. [25]And great crowds followed him from Galilee and the Decap'olis and Jerusalem and Judea and from beyond the Jordan.

The Beatitudes

5 Seeing the crowds, he went up on the mountain, and when he sat down his disciples came to him. [2]And he opened his mouth and taught them, saying:

3 “Blessed are the poor in spirit, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.

“Blessed are those who mourn, for they shall be comforted.

5 “Blessed are the meek, for they shall inherit the earth.

6 “Blessed are those who hunger and thirst for righteousness, for they shall be satisfied.

7 “Blessed are the merciful, for they shall obtain mercy.

8 “Blessed are the pure in heart, for they shall see God.

9 “Blessed are the peacemakers, for they shall be called sons of God.

10 “Blessed are those who are persecuted for righteousness’ sake, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.

11 “Blessed are you when men revile you and persecute you and utter all kinds of evil against you falsely on my account. [12]Rejoice and be glad, for your reward is great in heaven, for so men persecuted the prophets who were before you.

Salt and Light

13 “You are the salt of the earth; but if salt has lost its taste, how shall its saltiness be restored? It is no longer good for anything except to be thrown out and trodden under foot by men.

14 “You are the light of the world. A city set on a hill cannot be hidden.
15 Nor do men light a lamp and put it under a bushel, but on a stand, and it
gives light to all in the house. 16 Let your light so shine before men, that
they may see your good works and give glory to your Father who is in
heaven.

The Fulfillment of the Law and the Prophets

17 “Do not think that I have come to abolish the law and the prophets; I
have come not to abolish them but to fulfil them. * 18 For truly, I say to you,
till heaven and earth pass away, not an iota, not a dot, will pass from the law
until all is accomplished. 19 Whoever then relaxes one of the least of these
commandments and teaches men so, shall be called least in the kingdom of
heaven; but he who does them and teaches them shall be called great in the
kingdom of heaven. 20 For I tell you, unless your righteousness exceeds that
of the scribes and Pharisees, you will never enter the kingdom of heaven.

Concerning Anger

21 “You have heard that it was said to the men of old, ‘You shall not kill;
and whoever kills shall be liable to judgment.’ 22 But I say to you that every
one who is angry with his brother [i] shall be liable to judgment; whoever
insults [j] his brother shall be liable to the council, and whoever says, ‘You
fool!’ shall be liable to the hell [k] of fire. 23 So if you are offering your gift at
the altar, and there remember that your brother has something against you,
24 leave your gift there before the altar and go; first be reconciled to your
brother, and then come and offer your gift. 25 Make friends quickly with
your accuser, while you are going with him to court, lest your accuser hand
you over to the judge, and the judge to the guard, and you be put in prison;
26 truly, I say to you, you will never get out till you have paid the last penny.

Concerning Adultery

27 “You have heard that it was said, ‘You shall not commit adultery.’
28 But I say to you that every one who looks at a woman lustfully has
already committed adultery with her in his heart. 29 If your right eye causes
you to sin, pluck it out and throw it away; it is better that you lose one of
your members than that your whole body be thrown into hell. [k] * 30 And if
your right hand causes you to sin, cut it off and throw it away; it is better
that you lose one of your members than that your whole body go into hell. [k]

Concerning Divorce

31 “It was also said, ‘Whoever divorces his wife, let him give her a
certificate of divorce.’ 32But I say to you that every one who divorces his
wife, except on the ground of unchastity, * makes her an adulteress; and
whoever marries a divorced woman commits adultery.

Concerning Swearing Oaths

33 “Again you have heard that it was said to the men of old, ‘You shall not
swear falsely, but shall perform to the Lord what you have sworn.’ 34But I
say to you, Do not swear at all, either by heaven, for it is the throne of God,
35or by the earth, for it is his footstool, or by Jerusalem, for it is the city of
the great King. 36And do not swear by your head, for you cannot make one
hair white or black. 37Let what you say be simply ‘Yes’ or ‘No’; anything
more than this comes from the Evil One. l

Concerning Retaliation

38 “You have heard that it was said, ‘An eye for an eye and a tooth for a
tooth.’ 39But I say to you, Do not resist one who is evil. But if any one
strikes you on the right cheek, turn to him the other also; 40and if any one
would sue you and take your coat, let him have your cloak as well; 41and if
any one forces you to go one mile, go with him two miles. 42Give to him
who begs from you, and do not refuse him who would borrow from you.

Love for Enemies

43 “You have heard that it was said, ‘You shall love your neighbor and
hate your enemy.’ 44But I say to you, Love your enemies and pray for those
who persecute you, 45so that you may be sons of your Father who is in
heaven; for he makes his sun rise on the evil and on the good, and sends
rain on the just and on the unjust. 46For if you love those who love you,
what reward have you? Do not even the tax collectors do the same? 47And
if you salute only your brethren, what more are you doing than others? Do
not even the Gentiles do the same? 48You, therefore, must be perfect, as
your heavenly Father is perfect.

Concerning Almsgiving

6 “Beware of practicing your piety before men in order to be seen by
them; for then you will have no reward from your Father who is in heaven.
2 “Thus, when you give alms, sound no trumpet before you, as the
hypocrites do in the synagogues and in the streets, that they may be praised
by men. Truly, I say to you, they have their reward. 3But when you give

alms, do not let your left hand know what your right hand is doing, [4]so that your alms may be in secret; and your Father who sees in secret will reward you.

Concerning Prayer

[5] "And when you pray, you must not be like the hypocrites; for they love to stand and pray in the synagogues and at the street corners, that they may be seen by men. Truly, I say to you, they have their reward. [6]But when you pray, go into your room and shut the door and pray to your Father who is in secret; and your Father who sees in secret will reward you. [*]

[7] "And in praying do not heap up empty phrases as the Gentiles do; for they think that they will be heard for their many words. [8]Do not be like them, for your Father knows what you need before you ask him. [9]Pray then like this:

Our Father who art in heaven,
Hallowed be thy name.
[10]Thy kingdom come.
Thy will be done,
On earth as it is in heaven.
[11]Give us this day our daily bread; [m]
[12]And forgive us our trespasses,
As we forgive those who trespass against us;
[13]And lead us not into temptation,
But deliver us from evil. [n]

[14]For if you forgive men their trespasses, your heavenly Father also will forgive you; [15]but if you do not forgive men their trespasses, neither will your Father forgive your trespasses.

Concerning Fasting

[16] "And when you fast, do not look dismal, like the hypocrites, for they disfigure their faces that their fasting may be seen by men. Truly, I say to you, they have their reward. [17]But when you fast, anoint your head and wash your face, [18]that your fasting may not be seen by men but by your Father who is in secret; and your Father who sees in secret will reward you.

Concerning Treasures

[19] "Do not lay up for yourselves treasures on earth, where moth and rust [o] consume and where thieves break in and steal, [20]but lay up for yourselves

treasures in heaven, where neither moth nor rust [o] consumes and where thieves do not break in and steal. 21For where your treasure is, there will your heart be also.

The Sound Eye

22 “The eye is the lamp of the body. So, if your eye is sound, your whole body will be full of light; 23but if your eye is not sound, your whole body will be full of darkness. If then the light in you is darkness, how great is the darkness!

Serving Two Masters

24 “No one can serve two masters; for either he will hate the one and love the other, or he will be devoted to the one and despise the other. You cannot serve God and mammon. [*]

Do Not Be Anxious

25 “Therefore I tell you, do not be anxious about your life, what you shall eat or what you shall drink, nor about your body, what you shall put on. Is not life more than food, and the body more than clothing? 26Look at the birds of the air: they neither sow nor reap nor gather into barns, and yet your heavenly Father feeds them. Are you not of more value than they? 27And which of you by being anxious can add one cubit to his span of life? [p] 28And why are you anxious about clothing? Consider the lilies of the field, how they grow; they neither toil nor spin; 29yet I tell you, even Solomon in all his glory was not clothed like one of these. 30But if God so clothes the grass of the field, which today is alive and tomorrow is thrown into the oven, will he not much more clothe you, O you of little faith? 31Therefore do not be anxious, saying, ‘What shall we eat?’ or ‘What shall we drink?’ or ‘What shall we wear?’ 32For the Gentiles seek all these things; and your heavenly Father knows that you need them all. 33But seek first his kingdom and his righteousness, and all these things shall be yours as well.

34 “Therefore do not be anxious about tomorrow, for tomorrow will be anxious for itself. Let the day’s own trouble be sufficient for the day.

Judging Others

7 “Judge not, that you be not judged. 2For with the judgment you pronounce you will be judged, and the measure you give will be the measure you get. 3Why do you see the speck that is in your brother’s eye, but do not notice the log that is in your own eye? 4Or how can you say to

your brother, ‘Let me take the speck out of your eye,’ when there is the log in your own eye? 5You hypocrite, first take the log out of your own eye, and then you will see clearly to take the speck out of your brother’s eye.

Profaning the Holy

6 “Do not give dogs what is holy; and do not throw your pearls before swine, lest they trample them under foot and turn to attack you.

Ask, Seek, Knock

7 “Ask, and it will be given you; seek, and you will find; knock, and it will be opened to you. 8For every one who asks receives, and he who seeks finds, and to him who knocks it will be opened. 9Or what man of you, if his son asks him for bread, will give him a stone? 10Or if he asks for a fish, will give him a serpent? 11If you then, who are evil, know how to give good gifts to your children, how much more will your Father who is in heaven give good things to those who ask him! 12So whatever you wish that men would do to you, do so to them; for this is the law and the prophets.

The Narrow Gate

13 “Enter by the narrow gate; for the gate is wide and the way is easy, [q] that leads to destruction, and those who enter by it are many. 14For the gate is narrow and the way is hard, that leads to life, and those who find it are few.

False Prophets

15 “Beware of false prophets, who come to you in sheep’s clothing but inwardly are ravenous wolves. 16You will know them by their fruits. Are grapes gathered from thorns, or figs from thistles? 17So, every sound tree bears good fruit, but the bad tree bears evil fruit. 18A sound tree cannot bear evil fruit, nor can a bad tree bear good fruit. 19Every tree that does not bear good fruit is cut down and thrown into the fire. 20Thus you will know them by their fruits.

Concerning Self-Deception

21 “Not every one who says to me, ‘Lord, Lord,’ shall enter the kingdom of heaven, but he who does the will of my Father who is in heaven. 22On that day many will say to me, ‘Lord, Lord, did we not prophesy in your name, and cast out demons in your name, and do many mighty works in your name?’ 23And then will I declare to them, ‘I never knew you; depart from me, you evildoers.’

Hearers and Doers

24 “Every one then who hears these words of mine and does them will be
like a wise man who built his house upon the rock; 25and the rain fell, and
the floods came, and the winds blew and beat upon that house, but it did not
fall, because it had been founded on the rock. 26And every one who hears
these words of mine and does not do them will be like a foolish man who
built his house upon the sand; 27and the rain fell, and the floods came, and
the winds blew and beat against that house, and it fell; and great was the fall
of it.”
28 And when Jesus finished these sayings, the crowds were astonished at
his teaching, 29for he taught them as one who had authority, and not as their
scribes.

Jesus Cleanses a Leper

8 When he came down from the mountain, great crowds followed him;
2and behold, a leper came to him and knelt before him, saying, “Lord, if
you will, you can make me clean.” 3And he stretched out his hand and
touched him, saying, “I will; be clean.” And immediately his leprosy was
cleansed. * 4And Jesus said to him, “See that you say nothing to any one;
but go, show yourself to the priest, and offer the gift that Moses
commanded, for a proof to the people.” r

Jesus Heals a Centurion’s Servant

5 As he entered Caper'na-um, a centurion came forward to him, begging
him 6and saying, “Lord, my servant is lying paralyzed at home, in terrible
distress.” 7And he said to him, “I will come and heal him.” 8But the
centurion answered him, “Lord, I am not worthy to have you come under
my roof; but only say the word, and my servant will be healed. 9For I am a
man under authority, with soldiers under me; and I say to one, ‘Go,’ and he
goes, and to another, ‘Come,’ and he comes, and to my slave, ‘Do this,’ and
he does it.” 10When Jesus heard him, he marveled, and said to those who
followed him, “Truly, I say to you, not even s in Israel have I found such
faith. 11I tell you, many will come from east and west and sit at table with
Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob in the kingdom of heaven, 12while the sons of
the kingdom will be thrown into the outer darkness; there men will weep
and gnash their teeth.” 13And to the centurion Jesus said, “Go; let it be done
for you as you have believed.” And the servant was healed at that very
moment.

Jesus Heals Many at Peter’s House

14 And when Jesus entered Peter’s house, he saw his mother-in-law lying
sick with a fever; 15he touched her hand, and the fever left her, and she rose
and served him. 16That evening they brought to him many who were
possessed with demons; and he cast out the spirits with a word, and healed
all who were sick. 17This was to fulfil what was spoken by the prophet
Isaiah, “He took our infirmities and bore our diseases.”

Would-be Followers of Jesus

18 Now when Jesus saw great crowds around him, he gave orders to go
over to the other side. 19And a scribe came up and said to him, “Teacher, I
will follow you wherever you go.” 20And Jesus said to him, “Foxes have
holes, and birds of the air have nests; but the Son of man has nowhere to lay
his head.” 21Another of the disciples said to him, “Lord, let me first go and
bury my father.” 22But Jesus said to him, “Follow me, and leave the dead to
bury their own dead.”

Jesus Calms the Storm at Sea

23 And when he got into the boat, his disciples followed him. 24And
behold, there arose a great storm on the sea, so that the boat was being
swamped by the waves; but he was asleep. 25And they went and woke him,
saying, “Save us, Lord; we are perishing.” 26And he said to them, “Why are
you afraid, O men of little faith?” Then he rose and rebuked the winds and
the sea; and there was a great calm. 27And the men marveled, saying, “What
sort of man is this, that even winds and sea obey him?”

Jesus Heals the Gadarene Demoniacs

28 And when he came to the other side, to the country of the Gad'arenes, t
two demoniacs met him, coming out of the tombs, so fierce that no one
could pass that way. 29And behold, they cried out, “What have you to do
with us, O Son of God? Have you come here to torment us before the
time?” * 30Now a herd of many swine was feeding at some distance from
them. 31And the demons begged him, “If you cast us out, send us away into
the herd of swine.” 32And he said to them, “Go.” So they came out and
went into the swine; and behold, the whole herd rushed down the steep
bank into the sea, and perished in the waters. 33The herdsmen fled, and
going into the city they told everything, and what had happened to the
demoniacs. 34And behold, all the city came out to meet Jesus; and when
they saw him, they begged him to leave their neighborhood.

Jesus Heals a Paralytic

9 And getting into a boat he crossed over and came to his own city. [2]And behold, they brought to him a paralytic, lying on his bed; and when Jesus saw their faith, he said to the paralytic, “Take heart, my son; your sins are forgiven.” [3]And behold, some of the scribes said to themselves, “This man is blaspheming.” [4]But Jesus, knowing [u] their thoughts, said, “Why do you think evil in your hearts? [5]For which is easier, to say, ‘Your sins are forgiven,’ or to say, ‘Rise and walk’? [6]But that you may know that the Son of man has authority on earth to forgive sins”—he then said to the paralytic—“Rise, take up your bed and go home.” [7]And he rose and went home. [8]When the crowds saw it, they were afraid, and they glorified God, who had given such authority to men.

The Call of Matthew

9 As Jesus passed on from there, he saw a man called Matthew sitting at the tax office; and he said to him, “Follow me.” And he rose and followed him.

10 And as he sat at table [v] in the house, behold, many tax collectors and sinners came and sat down with Jesus and his disciples. [11]And when the Pharisees saw this, they said to his disciples, “Why does your teacher eat with tax collectors and sinners?” [12]But when he heard it, he said, “Those who are well have no need of a physician, but those who are sick. [13]Go and learn what this means, ‘I desire mercy, and not sacrifice.’ For I came not to call the righteous, but sinners.”

The Question about Fasting

14 Then the disciples of John came to him, saying, “Why do we and the Pharisees fast, [w] but your disciples do not fast?” [15]And Jesus said to them, “Can the wedding guests mourn as long as the bridegroom is with them? The days will come, when the bridegroom is taken away from them, and then they will fast. [16]And no one puts a piece of unshrunk cloth on an old garment, for the patch tears away from the garment, and a worse tear is made. [17]Neither is new wine put into old wineskins; if it is, the skins burst, and the wine is spilled, and the skins are destroyed; but new wine is put into fresh wineskins, and so both are preserved.”

A Girl Restored to Life anda Woman Healed

18 While he was thus speaking to them, behold, a ruler came in and knelt
before him, saying, “My daughter has just died; but come and lay your hand
on her, and she will live.” 19And Jesus rose and followed him, with his
disciples. 20And behold, a woman who had suffered from a hemorrhage for
twelve years came up behind him and touched the fringe of his garment;
21for she said to herself, “If I only touch his garment, I shall be made well.”
22Jesus turned, and seeing her he said, “Take heart, daughter; your faith has
made you well.” And instantly the woman was made well. 23And when
Jesus came to the ruler’s house, and saw the flute players, and the crowd
making a tumult, 24he said, “Depart; for the girl is not dead but sleeping.”
And they laughed at him. 25But when the crowd had been put outside, he
went in and took her by the hand, and the girl arose. 26And the report of this
went through all that district.

Jesus Heals Two Blind Men

27 And as Jesus passed on from there, two blind men followed him, crying
aloud, “Have mercy on us, Son of David.” 28When he entered the house, the
blind men came to him; and Jesus said to them, “Do you believe that I am
able to do this?” They said to him, “Yes, Lord.” 29Then he touched their
eyes, saying, “According to your faith let it be done to you.” 30And their
eyes were opened. And Jesus sternly charged them, “See that no one knows
it.” 31But they went away and spread his fame through all that district.

Jesus Heals a Man Who Was Mute

32 As they were going away, behold, a mute demoniac was brought to
him. 33And when the demon had been cast out, the mute man spoke; and the
crowds marveled, saying, “Never was anything like this seen in Israel.”
34But the Pharisees said, “He casts out demons by the prince of demons.”

The Harvest Is Plentiful,the Laborers Are Few

35 And Jesus went about all the cities and villages, teaching in their
synagogues and preaching the gospel of the kingdom, and healing every
disease and every infirmity. 36When he saw the crowds, he had compassion
for them, because they were harassed and helpless, like sheep without a
shepherd. 37Then he said to his disciples, “The harvest is plentiful, but the
laborers are few; 38pray therefore the Lord of the harvest to send out
laborers into his harvest.”

The Twelve Disciples

10 And he called to him his twelve disciples and gave them authority over unclean spirits, to cast them out, and to heal every disease and every infirmity. 2The names of the twelve apostles are these: first, Simon, who is called Peter, and Andrew his brother; James the son of Zeb'edee, and John his brother; 3Philip and Bartholomew; Thomas and Matthew the tax collector; James the son of Alphae'us, and Thaddae'us; x 4Simon the Cananaean, and Judas Iscariot, who betrayed him.

The Mission of the Twelve

5 These Twelve Jesus sent out, charging them, "Go nowhere among the Gentiles, and enter no town of the Samaritans, * 6but go rather to the lost sheep of the house of Israel. 7And preach as you go, saying, 'The kingdom of heaven is at hand.' 8Heal the sick, raise the dead, cleanse lepers, cast out demons. You received without pay, give without pay. 9Take no gold, nor silver, nor copper in your belts, 10no bag for your journey, nor two tunics, nor sandals, nor a staff; for the laborer deserves his food. 11And whatever town or village you enter, find out who is worthy in it, and stay with him until you depart. 12As you enter the house, salute it. 13And if the house is worthy, let your peace come upon it; but if it is not worthy, let your peace return to you. 14And if any one will not receive you or listen to your words, shake off the dust from your feet as you leave that house or town. 15Truly, I say to you, it shall be more tolerable on the day of judgment for the land of Sodom and Gomor'rah than for that town.

Coming Persecutions

16 "Behold, I send you out as sheep in the midst of wolves; so be wise as serpents and innocent as doves. 17Beware of men; for they will deliver you up to councils, and flog you in their synagogues, 18and you will be dragged before governors and kings for my sake, to bear testimony before them and the Gentiles. 19When they deliver you up, do not be anxious about how you are to speak or what you are to say; for what you are to say will be given to you in that hour; 20for it is not you who speak, but the Spirit of your Father speaking through you. 21Brother will deliver up brother to death, and the father his child, and children will rise against parents and have them put to death; 22and you will be hated by all for my name's sake. But he who endures to the end will be saved. 23When they persecute you in one town,

flee to the next; for truly, I say to you, you will not have gone through all the towns of Israel, before the Son of man comes.

24 “A disciple is not above his teacher, nor a servant [y] above his master;
25it is enough for the disciple to be like his teacher, and the servant [y] like his master. If they have called the master of the house Be-el'zebul, how much more will they malign those of his household.

Whom to Fear

26 “So have no fear of them; for nothing is covered that will not be revealed, or hidden that will not be known. **27**What I tell you in the dark, utter in the light; and what you hear whispered, proclaim upon the housetops. **28**And do not fear those who kill the body but cannot kill the soul; rather fear him who can destroy both soul and body in hell. [z] **29**Are not two sparrows sold for a penny? And not one of them will fall to the ground without your Father’s will. **30**But even the hairs of your head are all numbered. **31**Fear not, therefore; you are of more value than many sparrows.
32So every one who acknowledges me before men, I also will acknowledge before my Father who is in heaven; **33**but whoever denies me before men, I also will deny before my Father who is in heaven.

Taking Up One’s Cross

34 “Do not think that I have come to bring peace on earth; I have not come to bring peace, but a sword. **35**For I have come to set a man against his father, and a daughter against her mother, and a daughter-in-law against her mother-in-law; **36**and a man’s foes will be those of his own household.
37He who loves father or mother more than me is not worthy of me; and he who loves son or daughter more than me is not worthy of me; **38**and he who does not take his cross and follow me is not worthy of me. **39**He who finds his life will lose it, and he who loses his life for my sake will find it.

Rewards

40 “He who receives you receives me, and he who receives me receives him who sent me. **41**He who receives a prophet because he is a prophet shall receive a prophet’s reward, and he who receives a righteous man because he is a righteous man shall receive a righteous man’s reward. **42**And whoever gives to one of these little ones even a cup of cold water because he is a disciple, truly, I say to you, he shall not lose his reward.”

11 And when Jesus had finished instructing his twelve disciples, he went on from there to teach and preach in their cities.

Messengers from John the Baptist

2 Now when John heard in prison about the deeds of the Christ, he sent word by his disciples **3** and said to him, “Are you he who is to come, or shall we look for another?” * **4** And Jesus answered them, “Go and tell John what you hear and see: **5** the blind receive their sight and the lame walk, lepers are cleansed and the deaf hear, and the dead are raised up, and the poor have good news preached to them. **6** And blessed is he who takes no offense at me.”

Jesus Praises John the Baptist

7 As they went away, Jesus began to speak to the crowds concerning John: “What did you go out into the wilderness to behold? A reed shaken by the wind? **8** Why then did you go out? To see a man [a] dressed in soft robes? Behold, those who wear soft robes are in kings’ houses. **9** Why then did you go out? To see a prophet? [b] Yes, I tell you, and more than a prophet. **10** This is he of whom it is written,

‘Behold, I send my messenger before your face,
who shall prepare your way before you.’

11 Truly, I say to you, among those born of women there has arisen no one greater than John the Baptist; yet he who is least in the kingdom of heaven is greater than he. **12** From the days of John the Baptist until now the kingdom of heaven has suffered violence, [c] and men of violence take it by force. **13** For all the prophets and the law prophesied until John; **14** and if you are willing to accept it, he is Eli'jah who is to come. **15** He who has ears to hear, [d] let him hear.

16 “But to what shall I compare this generation? It is like children sitting in the market places and calling to their playmates,

17 ‘We piped to you, and you did not dance;
we wailed, and you did not mourn.’

18 For John came neither eating nor drinking, and they say, ‘He has a demon’; **19** the Son of man came eating and drinking, and they say, ‘Behold, a glutton and a drunkard, a friend of tax collectors and sinners!’ Yet wisdom is justified by her deeds.” [e]

Jesus Upbraids the Unrepentant Cities

20 Then he began to upbraid the cities where most of his mighty works had been done, because they did not repent. 21"Woe to you, Chora'zin! woe to you, Beth-sa'ida! for if the mighty works done in you had been done in Tyre and Si'don, they would have repented long ago in sackcloth and ashes. 22But I tell you, it shall be more tolerable on the day of judgment for Tyre and Si'don than for you. 23And you, Caper'na-um, will you be exalted to heaven? You shall be brought down to Hades. For if the mighty works done in you had been done in Sodom, it would have remained until this day. 24But I tell you that it shall be more tolerable on the day of judgment for the land of Sodom than for you."

Jesus Thanks His Father

25 At that time Jesus declared, "I thank you, Father, Lord of heaven and earth, that you have hidden these things from the wise and understanding and revealed them to infants; 26yes, Father, for such was your gracious will. f 27All things have been delivered to me by my Father; and no one knows the Son except the Father, and no one knows the Father except the Son and any one to whom the Son chooses to reveal him. * 28Come to me, all who labor and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest. 29Take my yoke upon you, and learn from me; for I am gentle and lowly in heart, and you will find rest for your souls. 30For my yoke is easy, and my burden is light."

Plucking Grain on the Sabbath

12 At that time Jesus went through the grainfields on the sabbath; his disciples were hungry, and they began to pluck heads of grain and to eat. 2But when the Pharisees saw it, they said to him, "Look, your disciples are doing what is not lawful to do on the sabbath." 3He said to them, "Have you not read what David did, when he was hungry, and those who were with him: 4how he entered the house of God and ate the showbread, which it was not lawful for him to eat nor for those who were with him, but only for the priests? 5Or have you not read in the law how on the sabbath the priests in the temple profane the sabbath, and are guiltless? 6I tell you, something greater than the temple is here. 7And if you had known what this means, 'I desire mercy, and not sacrifice,' you would not have condemned the guiltless. 8For the Son of man is lord of the sabbath."

The Man with a Withered Hand

9 And he went on from there, and entered their synagogue. 10And behold, there was a man with a withered hand. And they asked him, “Is it lawful to heal on the sabbath?” so that they might accuse him. 11He said to them, “What man of you, if he has one sheep and it falls into a pit on the sabbath, will not lay hold of it and lift it out? 12Of how much more value is a man than a sheep! So it is lawful to do good on the sabbath.” 13Then he said to the man, “Stretch out your hand.” And the man stretched it out, and it was restored, whole like the other. 14But the Pharisees went out and took counsel against him, how to destroy him. *

God’s Chosen Servant

15 Jesus, aware of this, withdrew from there. And many followed him, and he healed them all, 16and ordered them not to make him known. 17This was to fulfil what was spoken by the prophet Isaiah:

18“Behold, my servant whom I have chosen,
my beloved with whom my soul is well pleased.
I will put my Spirit upon him,
and he shall proclaim justice to the Gentiles.
19He will not wrangle or cry aloud,
nor will any one hear his voice in the streets;
20he will not break a bruised reed
or quench a smoldering wick,
till he brings justice to victory;
21 and in his name will the Gentiles hope.”

Jesus and Beelzebul

22 Then a blind and mute demoniac was brought to him, and he healed him, so that the mute man spoke and saw. 23And all the people were amazed, and said, “Can this be the Son of David?” 24But when the Pharisees heard it they said, “It is only by Be-el'zebul, * the prince of demons, that this man casts out demons.” 25Knowing their thoughts, he said to them, “Every kingdom divided against itself is laid waste, and no city or house divided against itself will stand; 26and if Satan casts out Satan, he is divided against himself; how then will his kingdom stand? 27And if I cast out demons by Be-el'zebul, by whom do your sons cast them out? Therefore they shall be your judges. 28But if it is by the Spirit of God that I cast out demons, then the kingdom of God has come upon you. 29Or how can one

enter a strong man’s house and plunder his goods, unless he first binds the strong man? Then indeed he may plunder his house. [30]He who is not with me is against me, and he who does not gather with me scatters. [31]Therefore I tell you, every sin and blasphemy will be forgiven men, but the blasphemy against the Spirit will not be forgiven. * [32]And whoever says a word against the Son of man will be forgiven; but whoever speaks against the Holy Spirit will not be forgiven, either in this age or in the age to come.

A Tree and Its Fruit

[33] “Either make the tree good, and its fruit good; or make the tree bad, and its fruit bad; for the tree is known by its fruit. [34]You brood of vipers! how can you speak good things, when you are evil? For out of the abundance of the heart the mouth speaks. [35]The good man out of his good treasure brings forth good, and the evil man out of his evil treasure brings forth evil. [36]I tell you, on the day of judgment men will render account for every careless word they utter; [37]for by your words you will be justified, and by your words you will be condemned.”

The Sign of Jonah

38 Then some of the scribes and Pharisees said to him, “Teacher, we wish to see a sign from you.” [39]But he answered them, “An evil and adulterous generation seeks for a sign; but no sign shall be given to it except the sign of the prophet Jonah. [40]For as Jonah was three days and three nights in the belly of the whale, so will the Son of man be three days and three nights in the heart of the earth. [41]The men of Nin'eveh will arise at the judgment with this generation and condemn it; for they repented at the preaching of Jonah, and behold, something greater than Jonah is here. [42]The queen of the South will arise at the judgment with this generation and condemn it; for she came from the ends of the earth to hear the wisdom of Solomon, and behold, something greater than Solomon is here.

The Return of the Unclean Spirit

[43] “When the unclean spirit has gone out of a man, he passes through waterless places seeking rest, but he finds none. [44]Then he says, ‘I will return to my house from which I came.’ And when he comes he finds it empty, swept, and put in order. [45]Then he goes and brings with him seven other spirits more evil than himself, and they enter and dwell there; and the last state of that man becomes worse than the first. So shall it be also with this evil generation.”

The True Kindred of Jesus

46 While he was still speaking to the people, behold, his mother and his brethren * stood outside, asking to speak to him. [g] **48**But he replied to the man who told him, “Who is my mother, and who are my brethren?” * **49**And stretching out his hand toward his disciples, he said, “Here are my mother and my brethren! **50**For whoever does the will of my Father in heaven is my brother, and sister, and mother.”

The Parable of the Sower

13 That same day Jesus went out of the house and sat beside the sea. **2**And great crowds gathered about him, so that he got into a boat and sat there; and the whole crowd stood on the beach. **3**And he told them many things in parables, saying: “A sower went out to sow. **4**And as he sowed, some seeds fell along the path, and the birds came and devoured them. **5**Other seeds fell on rocky ground, where they had not much soil, and immediately they sprang up, since they had no depth of soil, **6**but when the sun rose they were scorched; and since they had no root they withered away. **7**Other seeds fell upon thorns, and the thorns grew up and choked them. **8**Other seeds fell on good soil and brought forth grain, some a hundredfold, some sixty, some thirty. **9**He who has ears, [h] let him hear.”

The Purpose of the Parables

10 Then the disciples came and said to him, “Why do you speak to them in parables?” **11**And he answered them, “To you it has been given to know the secrets of the kingdom of heaven, but to them it has not been given. **12**For to him who has will more be given, and he will have abundance; but from him who has not, even what he has will be taken away. * **13**This is why I speak to them in parables, because seeing they do not see, and hearing they do not hear, nor do they understand. **14**With them indeed is fulfilled the prophecy of Isaiah which says:

‘You shall indeed hear but never understand,
and you shall indeed see but never perceive.
15For this people’s heart has grown dull,
and their ears are heavy of hearing,

and their eyes they have closed,
lest they should perceive with their eyes,
and hear with their ears,
and understand with their heart,
and turn for me to heal them.'

16 But blessed are your eyes, for they see, and your ears, for they hear. 17 Truly, I say to you, many prophets and righteous men longed to see what you see, and did not see it, and to hear what you hear, and did not hear it.

The Parable of the Sower Explained

18 "Hear then the parable of the sower. 19 When any one hears the word of the kingdom and does not understand it, the Evil One comes and snatches away what is sown in his heart; this is what was sown along the path. 20 As for what was sown on rocky ground, this is he who hears the word and immediately receives it with joy; 21 yet he has no root in himself, but endures for a while, and when tribulation or persecution arises on account of the word, immediately he falls away. [i] 22 As for what was sown among thorns, this is he who hears the word, but the cares of the world and the delight in riches choke the word, and it proves unfruitful. 23 As for what was sown on good soil, this is he who hears the word and understands it; he indeed bears fruit, and yields, in one case a hundredfold, in another sixty, and in another thirty."

The Parable of Weeds among the Wheat

24 Another parable he put before them, saying, "The kingdom of heaven may be compared to a man who sowed good seed in his field; 25 but while men were sleeping, his enemy came and sowed weeds among the wheat, and went away. 26 So when the plants came up and bore grain, then the weeds appeared also. 27 And the servants [j] of the householder came and said to him, 'Sir, did you not sow good seed in your field? How then has it weeds?' 28 He said to them, 'An enemy has done this.' The servants [j] said to him, 'Then do you want us to go and gather them?' 29 But he said, 'No; lest in gathering the weeds you root up the wheat along with them. 30 Let both grow together until the harvest; and at harvest time I will tell the reapers, Gather the weeds first and bind them in bundles to be burned, but gather the wheat into my barn.' "

The Parable of the Mustard Seed

31 Another parable he put before them, saying, “The kingdom of heaven is
like a grain of mustard seed which a man took and sowed in his field; 32it is
the smallest of all seeds, but when it has grown it is the greatest of shrubs
and becomes a tree, so that the birds of the air come and make nests in its
branches.”

The Parable of the Leaven

33 He told them another parable. “The kingdom of heaven is like leaven
which a woman took and hid in three measures of meal, till it was all
leavened.”

Why Jesus Speaks in Parables

34 All this Jesus said to the crowds in parables; indeed he said nothing to
them without a parable. 35This was to fulfil what was spoken by the
prophet: [k]

> “I will open my mouth in parables,
> I will utter what has been hidden since the foundation of the world.”

Jesus Explains the Parable of the Weeds

36 Then he left the crowds and went into the house. And his disciples
came to him, saying, “Explain to us the parable of the weeds of the field.”
37He answered, “He who sows the good seed is the Son of man; 38the field
is the world, and the good seed means the sons of the kingdom; the weeds
are the sons of the evil one, 39and the enemy who sowed them is the devil;
the harvest is the close of the age, and the reapers are angels. 40Just as the
weeds are gathered and burned with fire, so will it be at the close of the age.
41The Son of man will send his angels, and they will gather out of his
kingdom all causes of sin and all evildoers, 42and throw them into the
furnace of fire, where there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth. 43Then
the righteous will shine like the sun in the kingdom of their Father. He who
has ears, let him hear.

Three Parables about the Kingdom

44 “The kingdom of heaven is like treasure hidden in a field, which a man
found and covered up; then in his joy he goes and sells all that he has and
buys that field.

45 “Again, the kingdom of heaven is like a merchant in search of fine
pearls, 46who, on finding one pearl of great value, went and sold all that he
had and bought it.

47 “Again, the kingdom of heaven is like a net which was thrown into the
sea and gathered fish of every kind; 48when it was full, men drew it ashore
and sat down and sorted the good into vessels but threw away the bad. 49So
it will be at the close of the age. The angels will come out and separate the
evil from the righteous, 50and throw them into the furnace of fire, where
there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.

Treasures New and Old

51 “Have you understood all this?” They said to him, “Yes.” 52And he
said to them, “Therefore every scribe who has been trained for the kingdom
of heaven is like a householder who brings out of his treasure what is new
and what is old.” *

The Rejection of Jesus at Nazareth

53 And when Jesus had finished these parables, he went away from there,
54and coming to his own country he taught them in their synagogue, so that
they were astonished, and said, “Where did this man get this wisdom and
these mighty works? 55Is not this the carpenter’s son? Is not his mother
called Mary? And are not his brethren * James and Joseph and Simon and
Judas? 56And are not all his sisters with us? Where then did this man get all
this?” 57And they took offense at him. But Jesus said to them, “A prophet is
not without honor except in his own country and in his own house.” 58And
he did not do many mighty works there, because of their unbelief.

The Death of John the Baptist

14 At that time Herod the tetrarch heard about the fame of Jesus; 2and
he said to his servants, “This is John the Baptist; he has been raised from
the dead; that is why these powers are at work in him.” 3For Herod had
seized John and bound him and put him in prison, for the sake of Hero'di-
as, his brother Philip’s wife; [1] 4because John said to him, “It is not lawful for
you to have her.” 5And though he wanted to put him to death, he feared the
people, because they held him to be a prophet. 6But when Herod’s birthday
came, the daughter of Hero'di-as danced before the company, and pleased
Herod, 7so that he promised with an oath to give her whatever she might
ask. 8Prompted by her mother, she said, “Give me the head of John the
Baptist here on a platter.” 9And the king was sorry, but because of his oaths
and his guests he commanded it to be given; 10he sent and had John
beheaded in the prison, 11and his head was brought on a platter and given to

the girl, and she brought it to her mother. 12And his disciples came and took the body and buried it; and they went and told Jesus.

Feeding the Five Thousand

13 Now when Jesus heard this, he withdrew from there in a boat to a lonely place apart. But when the crowds heard it, they followed him on foot from the towns. 14As he went ashore he saw a great throng; and he had compassion on them, and healed their sick. 15When it was evening, the disciples came to him and said, “This is a lonely place, and the day is now over; send the crowds away to go into the villages and buy food for themselves.” 16Jesus said, “They need not go away; you give them something to eat.” 17They said to him, “We have only five loaves here and two fish.” 18And he said, “Bring them here to me.” 19Then he ordered the crowds to sit down on the grass; and taking the five loaves and the two fish he looked up to heaven, and blessed, and broke and gave the loaves to the disciples, and the disciples gave them to the crowds. 20And they all ate and were satisfied. And they took up twelve baskets full of the broken pieces left over. 21And those who ate were about five thousand men, besides women and children.

Jesus Walks on the Sea

22 Then he made the disciples get into the boat and go before him to the other side, while he dismissed the crowds. 23And after he had dismissed the crowds, he went up into the hills by himself to pray. When evening came, he was there alone, 24but the boat by this time was many furlongs distant from the land, [m] beaten by the waves; for the wind was against them. 25And in the fourth watch of the night he came to them, walking on the sea. 26But when the disciples saw him walking on the sea, they were terrified, saying, “It is a ghost!” And they cried out for fear. 27But immediately he spoke to them, saying, “Take heart, it is I; have no fear.”

28 And Peter answered him, “Lord, if it is you, bid me come to you on the water.” 29He said, “Come.” So Peter got out of the boat and walked on the water and came to Jesus; 30but when he saw the wind, [n] he was afraid, and beginning to sink he cried out, “Lord, save me.” 31Jesus immediately reached out his hand and caught him, saying to him, “O you of little faith, why did you doubt?” 32And when they got into the boat, the wind ceased. 33And those in the boat worshiped him, saying, “Truly you are the Son of God.” *

Jesus Heals the Sick in Gennesaret

34 And when they had crossed over, they came to land at Gennes'aret.
35 And when the men of that place recognized him, they sent round to all
that region and brought to him all that were sick, 36 and begged him that
they might only touch the fringe of his garment; and as many as touched it
were made well.

The Tradition of the Elders

15 Then Pharisees and scribes came to Jesus from Jerusalem and said,
2 "Why do your disciples transgress the tradition of the elders? For they do
not wash their hands when they eat." 3 He answered them, "And why do you
transgress the commandment of God for the sake of your tradition? 4 For
God commanded, 'Honor your father and your mother,' and, 'He who
speaks evil of father or mother, let him surely die.' 5 But you say, 'If any one
tells his father or his mother, What you would have gained from me is given
to God, o he need not honor his father.' * 6 So, for the sake of your tradition,
you have made void the word p of God. 7 You hypocrites! Well did Isaiah
prophesy of you, when he said:

> 8 'This people honors me with their lips,
> but their heart is far from me;
> 9 in vain do they worship me,
> teaching as doctrines the precepts of men.' "

Things That Defile a Man

10 And he called the people to him and said to them, "Hear and
understand: 11 not what goes into the mouth defiles a man, but what comes
out of the mouth, this defiles a man." 12 Then the disciples came and said to
him, "Do you know that the Pharisees were offended when they heard this
saying?" 13 He answered, "Every plant which my heavenly Father has not
planted will be rooted up. 14 Let them alone; they are blind guides. And if a
blind man leads a blind man, both will fall into a pit." 15 But Peter said to
him, "Explain the parable to us." 16 And he said, "Are you also still without
understanding? 17 Do you not see that whatever goes into the mouth passes
into the stomach, and so passes on? q 18 But what comes out of the mouth
proceeds from the heart, and this defiles a man. 19 For out of the heart come
evil thoughts, murder, adultery, fornication, theft, false witness, slander.

20 These are what defile a man; but to eat with unwashed hands does not
defile a man."

The Canaanite Woman's Faith

21 And Jesus went away from there and withdrew to the district of Tyre
and Si'don. 22 And behold, a Canaanite woman from that region came out
and cried, "Have mercy on me, O Lord, Son of David; my daughter is
severely possessed by a demon." 23 But he did not answer her a word. And
his disciples came and begged him, saying, "Send her away, for she is
crying after us." 24 He answered, "I was sent only to the lost sheep of the
house of Israel." * 25 But she came and knelt before him, saying, "Lord, help
me." 26 And he answered, "It is not fair to take the children's bread and
throw it to the dogs." 27 She said, "Yes, Lord, yet even the dogs eat the
crumbs that fall from their masters' table." 28 Then Jesus answered her, "O
woman, great is your faith! Let it be done for you as you desire." And her
daughter was healed instantly.

Jesus Heals Many People

29 And Jesus went on from there and passed along the Sea of Galilee. And
he went up on the mountain, and sat down there. 30 And great crowds came
to him, bringing with them the lame, the maimed, the blind, the mute, and
many others, and they put them at his feet, and he healed them, 31 so that the
throng wondered, when they saw the mute speaking, the maimed whole, the
lame walking, and the blind seeing; and they glorified the God of Israel.

Feeding the Four Thousand

32 Then Jesus called his disciples to him and said, "I have compassion on
the crowd, because they have been with me now three days, and have
nothing to eat; and I am unwilling to send them away hungry, lest they faint
on the way." 33 And the disciples said to him, "Where are we to get bread
enough in the desert to feed so great a crowd?" 34 And Jesus said to them,
"How many loaves have you?" They said, "Seven, and a few small fish."
35 And commanding the crowd to sit down on the ground, 36 he took the
seven loaves and the fish, and having given thanks he broke them and gave
them to the disciples, and the disciples gave them to the crowds. 37 And they
all ate and were satisfied; and they took up seven baskets full of the broken
pieces left over. 38 Those who ate were four thousand men, besides women

and children. 39And sending away the crowds, he got into the boat and went to the region of Mag'adan.

The Demand for a Sign

16 And the Pharisees and Sad'ducees came, and to test him they asked him to show them a sign from heaven. 2He answered them, r "When it is evening, you say, 'It will be fair weather; for the sky is red.' 3And in the morning, 'It will be stormy today, for the sky is red and threatening.' You know how to interpret the appearance of the sky, but you cannot interpret the signs of the times. 4An evil and adulterous generation seeks for a sign, but no sign shall be given to it except the sign of Jonah." So he left them and departed.

The Leaven of the Pharisees and Sadducees

5 When the disciples reached the other side, they had forgotten to bring any bread. 6Jesus said to them, "Take heed and beware of the leaven of the Pharisees and Sad'ducees." 7And they discussed it among themselves, saying, "We brought no bread." 8But Jesus, aware of this, said, "O men of little faith, why do you discuss among yourselves the fact that you have no bread? 9Do you not yet perceive? Do you not remember the five loaves of the five thousand, and how many baskets you gathered? 10Or the seven loaves of the four thousand, and how many baskets you gathered? 11How is it that you fail to perceive that I did not speak about bread? Beware of the leaven of the Pharisees and Sad'ducees." 12Then they understood that he did not tell them to beware of the leaven of bread, but of the teaching of the Pharisees and Sad'ducees.

Peter's Declaration That Jesus Is the Christ

13 Now when Jesus came into the district of Caesare'a Philip'pi, he asked his disciples, "Who do men say that the Son of man is?" 14And they said, "Some say John the Baptist, others say Eli'jah, and others Jeremiah or one of the prophets." * 15He said to them, "But who do you say that I am?" 16Simon Peter replied, "You are the Christ, the Son of the living God." * 17And Jesus answered him, "Blessed are you, Simon Bar-Jona! For flesh and blood has not revealed this to you, but my Father who is in heaven. 18And I tell you, you are Peter, s and on this rock t I will build my Church, and the gates of Hades u shall not prevail against it. * 19I will give you the keys of the kingdom of heaven, * and whatever you bind on earth shall be

bound in heaven, and whatever you loose on earth shall be loosed in heaven." [20]Then he strictly charged the disciples to tell no one that he was the Christ.

Jesus Foretells His Death and Resurrection

[21] From that time Jesus began to show his disciples that he must go to Jerusalem and suffer many things from the elders and chief priests and scribes, and be killed, and on the third day be raised. [22]And Peter took him and began to rebuke him, saying, "God forbid, Lord! This shall never happen to you." [23]But he turned and said to Peter, "Get behind me, Satan! You are a hindrance [v] to me; for you are not on the side of God, but of men."

The Cross and Self-Denial

24 Then Jesus told his disciples, "If any man would come after me, let him deny himself and take up his cross and follow me. [25]For whoever would save his life will lose it, and whoever loses his life for my sake will find it. [26]For what will it profit a man, if he gains the whole world and forfeits his life? * Or what shall a man give in return for his life? * [27]For the Son of man is to come with his angels in the glory of his Father, and then he will repay every man for what he has done. [28]Truly, I say to you, there are some standing here who will not taste death before they see the Son of man coming in his kingdom."

The Transfiguration

17 And after six days Jesus took with him Peter and James and John his brother, and led them up a high mountain apart. [2]And he was transfigured before them, and his face shone like the sun, and his garments became white as light. [3]And behold, there appeared to them Moses and Eli'jah, talking with him. [4]And Peter said to Jesus, "Lord, it is well that we are here; if you wish, I will make three booths here, one for you and one for Moses and one for Eli'jah." * [5]He was still speaking, when behold, a bright cloud overshadowed them, and a voice from the cloud said, "This is my beloved Son, [w] with whom I am well pleased; listen to him." [6]When the disciples heard this, they fell on their faces, and were filled with awe. [7]But Jesus came and touched them, saying, "Rise, and have no fear." [8]And when they lifted up their eyes, they saw no one but Jesus only.

9 And as they were coming down the mountain, Jesus commanded them,
“Tell no one the vision, until the Son of man is raised from the dead.” 10 And
the disciples asked him, “Then why do the scribes say that first Eli'jah must
come?” 11 He replied, “Eli'jah does come, and he is to restore all things;
12 but I tell you that Eli'jah has already come, and they did not know him,
but did to him whatever they pleased. So also the Son of man will suffer at
their hands.” 13 Then the disciples understood that he was speaking to them
of John the Baptist.

Jesus Cures an Epileptic Boy

14 And when they came to the crowd, a man came up to him and kneeling
before him said, 15 “Lord, have mercy on my son, for he is an epileptic and
he suffers terribly; for often he falls into the fire, and often into the water.
16 And I brought him to your disciples, and they could not heal him.” 17 And
Jesus answered, “O faithless and perverse generation, how long am I to be
with you? How long am I to bear with you? Bring him here to me.” 18 And
Jesus rebuked him, and the demon came out of him, and the boy was cured
instantly. 19 Then the disciples came to Jesus privately and said, “Why could
we not cast it out?” 20 He said to them, “Because of your little faith. For
truly, I say to you, if you have faith as a grain of mustard seed, you will say
to this mountain, ‘Move from here to there,’ and it will move; and nothing
will be impossible to you.” [x]

Jesus Again Foretells His Deathand Resurrection

22 As they were gathering [y] in Galilee, Jesus said to them, “The Son of
man is to be delivered into the hands of men, 23 and they will kill him, and
he will be raised on the third day.” And they were greatly distressed.

Jesus and the Temple Tax

24 When they came to Caper'na-um, the collectors of the half-shekel tax
went up to Peter and said, “Does not your teacher pay the tax?” 25 He said,
“Yes.” And when he came home, Jesus spoke to him first, saying, “What do
you think, Simon? From whom do kings of the earth take toll or tribute?
From their sons or from others?” 26 And when he said, “From others,” Jesus
said to him, “Then the sons are free. 27 However, not to give offense to
them, go to the sea and cast a hook, and take the first fish that comes up,
and when you open its mouth you will find a shekel; take that and give it to
them for me and for yourself.”

True Greatness

18 At that time the disciples came to Jesus, saying, “Who is the greatest
in the kingdom of heaven?” 2And calling to him a child, he put him in the
midst of them, 3and said, “Truly, I say to you, unless you turn and become
like children, you will never enter the kingdom of heaven. 4Whoever
humbles himself like this child, he is the greatest in the kingdom of heaven.

Temptations to Sin

5 “Whoever receives one such child in my name receives me; 6but
whoever causes one of these little ones who believe in me to sin, [z] it would
be better for him to have a great millstone fastened round his neck and to be
drowned in the depth of the sea.

7 “Woe to the world for temptations to sin! [a] For it is necessary that
temptations come, but woe to the man by whom the temptation comes!
8And if your hand or your foot causes you to sin, [z] cut it off and throw it
from you; it is better for you to enter life maimed or lame than with two
hands or two feet to be thrown into the eternal fire. 9And if your eye causes
you to sin, [z] pluck it out and throw it from you; it is better for you to enter
life with one eye than with two eyes to be thrown into the hell [b] * of fire.

The Parable of the Lost Sheep

10 “See that you do not despise one of these little ones; for I tell you that
in heaven their angels always behold the face of my Father who is in
heaven. [c] 12What do you think? If a man has a hundred sheep, and one of
them has gone astray, does he not leave the ninety-nine on the hills and go
in search of the one that went astray? 13And if he finds it, truly, I say to you,
he rejoices over it more than over the ninety-nine that never went astray.
14So it is not the will of my [d] Father who is in heaven that one of these little
ones should perish.

Binding and Loosing of Sins

15 “If your brother sins against you, go and tell him his fault, between you
and him alone. If he listens to you, you have gained your brother. 16But if
he does not listen, take one or two others along with you, that every word
may be confirmed by the evidence of two or three witnesses. 17If he refuses
to listen to them, tell it to the Church; and if he refuses to listen even to the
Church, let him be to you as a Gentile and a tax collector. 18Truly, I say to
you, whatever you bind on earth shall be bound in heaven, and whatever
you loose on earth shall be loosed in heaven. * 19Again I say to you, if two

of you agree on earth about anything they ask, it will be done for them by my Father in heaven. 20For where two or three are gathered in my name, there am I in the midst of them."

Repeated Forgiveness

21 Then Peter came up and said to him, "Lord, how often shall my brother sin against me, and I forgive him? As many as seven times?" 22Jesus said to him, "I do not say to you seven times, but seventy times seven. [e]

The Parable of the Unmerciful Servant

23 "Therefore the kingdom of heaven may be compared to a king who wished to settle accounts with his servants. 24When he began the reckoning, one was brought to him who owed him ten thousand talents; [f] 25and as he could not pay, his lord ordered him to be sold, with his wife and children and all that he had, and payment to be made. 26So the servant fell on his knees, imploring him, 'Lord, have patience with me, and I will pay you everything.' 27And out of pity for him the lord of that servant released him and forgave him the debt. 28But that same servant, as he went out, came upon one of his fellow servants who owed him a hundred denarii; [g] and seizing him by the throat he said, 'Pay what you owe.' 29So his fellow servant fell down and pleaded with him, 'Have patience with me, and I will pay you.' 30He refused and went and put him in prison till he should pay the debt. 31When his fellow servants saw what had taken place, they were greatly distressed, and they went and reported to their lord all that had taken place. 32Then his lord summoned him and said to him, 'You wicked servant! I forgave you all that debt because you pleaded with me; 33and should not you have had mercy on your fellow servant, as I had mercy on you?' 34And in anger his lord delivered him to the jailers, [h] till he should pay all his debt. 35So also my heavenly Father will do to every one of you, if you do not forgive your brother from your heart."

Teachings about Divorce

19 Now when Jesus had finished these sayings, he went away from Galilee and entered the region of Judea beyond the Jordan; 2and large crowds followed him, and he healed them there.

3 And Pharisees came up to him and tested him by asking, "Is it lawful to divorce one's wife for any cause?" 4He answered, "Have you not read that he who made them from the beginning made them male and female, 5and

said, ‘For this reason a man shall leave his father and mother and be joined to his wife, and the two shall become one’? [i] 6So they are no longer two but one. [i] What therefore God has joined together, let no man put asunder.” 7They said to him, “Why then did Moses command one to give a certificate of divorce, and to put her away?” 8He said to them, “For your hardness of heart Moses allowed you to divorce your wives, but from the beginning it was not so. 9And I say to you: whoever divorces his wife, except for unchastity, [j] and marries another, commits adultery; and he who marries a divorced woman, commits adultery.” [k] *

10 The disciples said to him, “If such is the case of a man with his wife, it is not expedient to marry.” 11But he said to them, “Not all men can receive this precept, but only those to whom it is given. 12For there are eunuchs who have been so from birth, and there are eunuchs who have been made eunuchs by men, and there are eunuchs who have made themselves eunuchs for the sake of the kingdom of heaven. He who is able to receive this, let him receive it.” *

Jesus Blesses the Children

13 Then children were brought to him that he might lay his hands on them and pray. The disciples rebuked the people; 14but Jesus said, “Let the children come to me, and do not hinder them; for to such belongs the kingdom of heaven.” 15And he laid his hands on them and went away.

The Rich Young Man

16 And behold, one came up to him, saying, “Teacher, what good deed must I do, to have eternal life?” 17And he said to him, “Why do you ask me about what is good? One there is who is good. If you would enter life, keep the commandments.” 18He said to him, “Which?” And Jesus said, “You shall not kill, You shall not commit adultery, You shall not steal, You shall not bear false witness, 19Honor your father and mother, and, You shall love your neighbor as yourself.” 20The young man said to him, “All these I have observed; what do I still lack?” 21Jesus said to him, “If you would be perfect, go, sell what you possess and give to the poor, and you will have treasure in heaven; and come, follow me.” 22When the young man heard this he went away sorrowful; for he had great possessions.

23 And Jesus said to his disciples, “Truly, I say to you, it will be hard for a rich man to enter the kingdom of heaven. 24Again I tell you, it is easier for a camel to go through the eye of a needle than for a rich man to enter the

kingdom of God.” 25When the disciples heard this they were greatly astonished, saying, “Who then can be saved?” 26But Jesus looked at them and said to them, “With men this is impossible, but with God all things are possible.” 27Then Peter said in reply, “Behold, we have left everything and followed you. What then shall we have?” 28Jesus said to them, “Truly, I say to you, in the new world, when the Son of man shall sit on his glorious throne, you who have followed me will also sit on twelve thrones, judging the twelve tribes of Israel. 29And every one who has left houses or brothers or sisters or father or mother or children or lands, for my name’s sake, will receive a hundredfold, [l] and inherit eternal life. 30But many that are first will be last, and the last first.

The Laborers in the Vineyard

20 “For the kingdom of heaven is like a householder who went out early in the morning to hire laborers for his vineyard. 2After agreeing with the laborers for a denarius [m] a day, he sent them into his vineyard. 3And going out about the third hour he saw others standing idle in the market place; 4and to them he said, ‘You go into the vineyard too, and whatever is right I will give you.’ So they went. 5Going out again about the sixth hour and the ninth hour, he did the same. 6And about the eleventh hour he went out and found others standing; and he said to them, ‘Why do you stand here idle all day?’ 7They said to him, ‘Because no one has hired us.’ He said to them, ‘You go into the vineyard too.’ 8And when evening came, the owner of the vineyard said to his steward, ‘Call the laborers and pay them their wages, beginning with the last, up to the first.’ 9And when those hired about the eleventh hour came, each of them received a denarius. 10Now when the first came, they thought they would receive more; but each of them also received a denarius. 11And on receiving it they grumbled at the householder, 12saying, ‘These last worked only one hour, and you have made them equal to us who have borne the burden of the day and the scorching heat.’ 13But he replied to one of them, ‘Friend, I am doing you no wrong; did you not agree with me for a denarius? 14Take what belongs to you, and go; I choose to give to this last as I give to you. 15Am I not allowed to do what I choose with what belongs to me? Or do you begrudge my generosity?’ [n] 16So the last will be first, and the first last.”

A Third Time Jesus ForetellsHis Death and Resurrection

17 And as Jesus was going up to Jerusalem, he took the twelve disciples
aside, and on the way he said to them, 18"Behold, we are going up to
Jerusalem; and the Son of man will be delivered to the chief priests and
scribes, and they will condemn him to death, 19and deliver him to the
Gentiles to be mocked and scourged and crucified, and he will be raised on
the third day."

The Request of the Motherof James and John

20 Then the mother of the sons of Zeb'edee came up to him, with her sons,
and kneeling before him she asked him for something. 21And he said to her,
"What do you want?" She said to him, "Command that these two sons of
mine may sit, one at your right hand and one at your left, in your kingdom."
22But Jesus answered, "You do not know what you are asking. Are you able
to drink the chalice that I am to drink?" They said to him, "We are able."
23He said to them, "You will drink my chalice, but to sit at my right hand
and at my left is not mine to grant, but it is for those for whom it has been
prepared by my Father." 24And when the Ten heard it, they were indignant
at the two brothers. 25But Jesus called them to him and said, "You know
that the rulers of the Gentiles lord it over them, and their great men exercise
authority over them. 26It shall not be so among you; but whoever would be
great among you must be your servant, 27and whoever would be first among
you must be your slave; 28even as the Son of man came not to be served but
to serve, and to give his life as a ransom for many."

Jesus Heals Two Blind Men

29 And as they went out of Jericho, a great crowd followed him. 30And
behold, two blind men sitting by the roadside, when they heard that Jesus
was passing by, cried out, o "Have mercy on us, Son of David!" 31The
crowd rebuked them, telling them to be silent; but they cried out the more,
"Lord, have mercy on us, Son of David!" 32And Jesus stopped and called
them, saying, "What do you want me to do for you?" 33They said to him,
"Lord, let our eyes be opened." 34And Jesus in pity touched their eyes, and
immediately they received their sight and followed him.

Jesus' Entry into Jerusalem

21 And when they drew near to Jerusalem and came to Beth'phage, to
the Mount of Olives, then Jesus sent two disciples, 2saying to them, "Go
into the village opposite you, and immediately you will find a donkey tied,

and a colt with her; untie them and bring them to me. 3If any one says anything to you, you shall say, ‘The Lord has need of them,’ and he will send them immediately.” 4This took place to fulfil what was spoken by the prophet, saying,

5“Tell the daughter of Zion,
Behold, your king is coming to you,
humble, and mounted on a donkey,
and on a colt, the foal of a donkey.”

6The disciples went and did as Jesus had directed them; 7they brought the donkey and the colt, and put their garments on them, and he sat on them. 8Most of the crowd spread their garments on the road, and others cut branches from the trees and spread them on the road. 9And the crowds that went before him and that followed him shouted, “Hosanna to the Son of David! Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord! Hosanna in the highest!” * 10And when he entered Jerusalem, all the city was stirred, saying, “Who is this?” 11And the crowds said, “This is the prophet Jesus from Nazareth of Galilee.”

Jesus Cleanses the Temple

12 And Jesus entered the temple of God [p] and drove out all who sold and bought in the temple, and he overturned the tables of the money-changers and the seats of those who sold pigeons. 13He said to them, “It is written, ‘My house shall be called a house of prayer’; but you make it a den of robbers.”

14 And the blind and the lame came to him in the temple, and he healed them. 15But when the chief priests and the scribes saw the wonderful things that he did, and the children crying out in the temple, “Hosanna to the Son of David!” they were indignant; 16and they said to him, “Do you hear what these are saying?” And Jesus said to them, “Yes; have you never read,

‘Out of the mouths of babies and infants
you have brought perfect praise’?”

17And leaving them, he went out of the city to Beth'any and lodged there.

Jesus Curses the Fig Tree

18 In the morning, as he was returning to the city, he was hungry. 19And seeing a fig tree by the wayside he went to it, and found nothing on it but leaves only. And he said to it, “May no fruit ever come from you again!”

And the fig tree withered at once. [20]When the disciples saw it they marveled, saying, “How did the fig tree wither at once?” [21]And Jesus answered them, “Truly, I say to you, if you have faith and never doubt, you will not only do what has been done to the fig tree, but even if you say to this mountain, ‘Be taken up and cast into the sea,’ it will be done. [22]And whatever you ask in prayer, you will receive, if you have faith.”

The Authority of Jesus Questioned

[23] And when he entered the temple, the chief priests and the elders of the people came up to him as he was teaching, and said, “By what authority are you doing these things, and who gave you this authority?” * [24]Jesus answered them, “I also will ask you a question; and if you tell me the answer, then I also will tell you by what authority I do these things. [25]The baptism of John, where was it from? From heaven or from men?” And they argued with one another, “If we say, ‘From heaven,’ he will say to us, ‘Why then did you not believe him?’ [26]But if we say, ‘From men,’ we are afraid of the multitude; for all hold that John was a prophet.” [27]So they answered Jesus, “We do not know.” And he said to them, “Neither will I tell you by what authority I do these things.

The Parable of the Two Sons

[28] “What do you think? A man had two sons; and he went to the first and said, ‘Son, go and work in the vineyard today.’ [29]And he answered, ‘I will not’; but afterward he repented and went. [30]And he went to the second and said the same; and he answered, ‘I go, sir,’ but did not go. [31]Which of the two did the will of his father?” They said, “The first.” Jesus said to them, “Truly, I say to you, the tax collectors and the harlots go into the kingdom of God before you. [32]For John came to you in the way of righteousness, and you did not believe him, but the tax collectors and the harlots believed him; and even when you saw it, you did not afterward repent and believe him.

The Parable of the Wicked Tenants

[33] “Hear another parable. * There was a householder who planted a vineyard, and set a hedge around it, and dug a wine press in it, and built a tower, and leased it to tenants, and went into another country. [34]When the season of fruit drew near, he sent his servants to the tenants, to get his fruit; [35]and the tenants took his servants and beat one, killed another, and stoned another. [36]Again he sent other servants, more than the first; and they did the same to them. [37]Afterward he sent his son to them, saying, ‘They will

respect my son.’ [38]But when the tenants saw the son, they said to themselves, ‘This is the heir; come, let us kill him and have his inheritance.’ [39]And they took him and cast him out of the vineyard, and killed him. [40]When therefore the owner of the vineyard comes, what will he do to those tenants?” [41]They said to him, “He will put those wretches to a miserable death, and lease the vineyard to other tenants who will give him the fruits in their seasons.”

The Stone Which the Builders Rejected

[42] Jesus said to them, “Have you never read in the Scriptures:

‘The very stone which the builders rejected
has become the cornerstone;
this was the Lord’s doing,
and it is marvelous in our eyes’?

[43]Therefore I tell you, the kingdom of God will be taken away from you and given to a nation producing the fruits of it. [44]And he who falls on this stone will be broken to pieces; but when it falls on any one, it will crush him.” [q]

45 When the chief priests and the Pharisees heard his parables, they perceived that he was speaking about them. [46]But when they tried to arrest him, they feared the multitudes, because they held him to be a prophet.

The Parable of the Marriage Feast

22 And again Jesus spoke to them in para-bes, saying, [2]“The kingdom of heaven may be compared to a king who gave a marriage feast for his son, [3]and sent his servants to call those who were invited to the marriage feast; but they would not come. [4]Again he sent other servants, saying, ‘Tell those who are invited, Behold, I have made ready my dinner, my oxen and my fat calves are killed, and everything is ready; come to the marriage feast.’ [5]But they made light of it and went off, one to his farm, another to his business, [6]while the rest seized his servants, treated them shamefully, and killed them. [7]The king was angry, and he sent his troops and destroyed those murderers and burned their city. [8]Then he said to his servants, ‘The wedding is ready, but those invited were not worthy. [9]Go therefore to the streets, and invite to the marriage feast as many as you find.’ [10]And those servants went out into the streets and gathered all whom they found, both bad and good; so the wedding hall was filled with guests.

11 “But when the king came in to look at the guests, he saw there a man who had no wedding garment; * [12]and he said to him, ‘Friend, how did you get in here without a wedding garment?’ And he was speechless. [13]Then the king said to the attendants, ‘Bind him hand and foot, and cast him into the outer darkness, where there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.’ [14]For many are called, but few are chosen.”

The Question about Paying Taxes

15 Then the Pharisees went and took counsel how to entangle him in his talk. [16]And they sent their disciples to him, along with the Hero'di-ans, saying, “Teacher, we know that you are true, and teach the way of God truthfully, and care for no man; for you do not regard the position of men. [17]Tell us, then, what you think. Is it lawful to pay taxes to Caesar, or not?” [18]But Jesus, aware of their malice, said, “Why put me to the test, you hypocrites? [19]Show me the money for the tax.” And they brought him a coin. [r] [20]And Jesus said to them, “Whose likeness and inscription is this?” [21]They said, “Caesar’s.” Then he said to them, “Render therefore to Caesar the things that are Caesar’s, and to God the things that are God’s.” [22]When they heard it, they marveled; and they left him and went away.

The Question about Man’s Resurrection

23 The same day Sad'ducees came to him, who say that there is no resurrection; and they asked him a question, [24]saying, “Teacher, Moses said, ‘If a man dies, having no children, his brother must marry the widow, and raise up children for his brother.’ [25]Now there were seven brothers among us; the first married, and died, and having no children left his wife to his brother. [26]So too the second and third, down to the seventh. [27]After them all, the woman died. [28]In the resurrection, therefore, to which of the seven will she be wife? For they all had her.”

29 But Jesus answered them, “You are wrong, because you know neither the Scriptures nor the power of God. [30]For in the resurrection they neither marry nor are given in marriage, but are like angels [s] in heaven. [31]And as for the resurrection of the dead, have you not read what was said to you by God, [32]‘I am the God of Abraham, and the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob’? He is not God of the dead, but of the living.” [33]And when the crowd heard it, they were astonished at his teaching.

The Greatest Commandment

34 But when the Pharisees heard that he had silenced the Sad'ducees, they
came together. 35And one of them, a lawyer, asked him a question, to test
him. 36"Teacher, which is the great commandment in the law?" 37And he
said to him, "You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart, and with
all your soul, and with all your mind. 38This is the great and first
commandment. 39And a second is like it, You shall love your neighbor as
yourself. 40On these two commandments depend all the law and the
prophets."

A Question about the Christ

41 Now while the Pharisees were gathered together, Jesus asked them a
question, 42saying, "What do you think of the Christ? Whose son is he?"
They said to him, "The son of David." 43He said to them, "How is it then
that David, inspired by the Spirit, t calls him Lord, saying,

44'The Lord said to my Lord,
Sit at my right hand,
till I put your enemies under your feet'?

45If David thus calls him Lord, how is he his son?" 46And no one was
able to answer him a word, nor from that day did any one dare to ask him
any more questions.

Jesus Denounces the Hypocrisyof the Scribes and Pharisees

23 Then said Jesus to the crowds and to his disciples, 2"The scribes and
the Pharisees sit on Moses' seat; 3so practice and observe whatever they tell
you, but not what they do; for they preach, but do not practice. 4They bind
heavy burdens, hard to bear, u and lay them on men's shoulders; but they
themselves will not move them with their finger. 5They do all their deeds to
be seen by men; for they make their phylacteries * broad and their fringes
long, 6and they love the place of honor at feasts and the best seats in the
synagogues, 7and salutations in the market places, and being called rabbi by
men. 8But you are not to be called rabbi, for you have one teacher, and you
are all brethren. 9And call no man your father on earth, for you have one
Father, who is in heaven. * 10Neither be called masters, for you have one
master, the Christ. 11He who is greatest among you shall be your servant;
12whoever exalts himself will be humbled, and whoever humbles himself
will be exalted.

13 “But woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! because you shut
the kingdom of heaven against men; for you neither enter yourselves, nor
allow those who would enter to go in. [v] 15 Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees,
hypocrites! for you traverse sea and land to make a single proselyte, and
when he becomes a proselyte, you make him twice as much a child of hell [w]
as yourselves.
16 “Woe to you, blind guides, who say, ‘If any one swears by the temple,
it is nothing; but if any one swears by the gold of the temple, he is bound by
his oath.’ 17 You blind fools! For which is greater, the gold or the temple that
has made the gold sacred? 18 And you say, ‘If any one swears by the altar, it
is nothing; but if any one swears by the gift that is on the altar, he is bound
by his oath.’ 19 You blind men! For which is greater, the gift or the altar that
makes the gift sacred? 20 So he who swears by the altar, swears by it and by
everything on it; 21 and he who swears by the temple, swears by it and by
him who dwells in it; 22 and he who swears by heaven, swears by the throne
of God and by him who sits upon it.
23 “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for you tithe mint and
dill and cummin, and have neglected the weightier matters of the law,
justice and mercy and faith; these you ought to have done, without
neglecting the others. 24 You blind guides, straining out a gnat and
swallowing a camel!
25 “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for you cleanse the
outside of the cup and of the plate, but inside they are full of extortion and
rapacity. 26 You blind Pharisee! first cleanse the inside of the cup and of the
plate, that the outside also may be clean.
27 “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for you are like
whitewashed tombs, which outwardly appear beautiful, but within they are
full of dead men’s bones and all uncleanness. 28 So you also outwardly
appear righteous to men, but within you are full of hypocrisy and iniquity.
29 “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites! for you build the tombs
of the prophets and adorn the monuments of the righteous, 30 saying, ‘If we
had lived in the days of our fathers, we would not have taken part with them
in shedding the blood of the prophets.’ 31 Thus you witness against
yourselves, that you are sons of those who murdered the prophets. 32 Fill up,
then, the measure of your fathers. 33 You serpents, you brood of vipers, how
are you to escape being sentenced to hell? [w] 34 Therefore I send you

prophets and wise men and scribes, some of whom you will kill and crucify, and some you will scourge in your synagogues and persecute from town to town, 35that upon you may come all the righteous blood shed on earth, from the blood of innocent Abel to the blood of Zechari'ah the son of Barachi'ah, whom you murdered between the sanctuary and the altar. 36Truly, I say to you, all this will come upon this generation.

The Lament over Jerusalem

37 "O Jerusalem, Jerusalem, killing the prophets and stoning those who are sent to you! How often would I have gathered your children together as a hen gathers her brood under her wings, and you would not! 38Behold, your house is forsaken and desolate. x 39For I tell you, you will not see me again, until you say, 'Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord.' "

The Destruction of the Temple Foretold

24 Jesus left the temple and was going away, when his disciples came to point out to him the buildings of the temple. * 2But he answered them, "You see all these, do you not? Truly, I say to you, there will not be left here one stone upon another, that will not be thrown down."

Signs of Jesus' Coming and ofthe Close of the Age

3 As he sat on the Mount of Olives, the disciples came to him privately, saying, "Tell us, when will this be, and what will be the sign of your coming and of the close of the age?" 4And Jesus answered them, "Take heed that no one leads you astray. 5For many will come in my name, saying, 'I am the Christ,' and they will lead many astray. 6And you will hear of wars and rumors of wars; see that you are not alarmed; for this must take place, but the end is not yet. 7For nation will rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom, and there will be famines and earthquakes in various places: 8all this is but the beginning of the sufferings.

Persecutions Foretold

9 "Then they will deliver you up to tribulation, and put you to death; and you will be hated by all nations for my name's sake. 10And then many will fall away, y and betray one another, and hate one another. 11And many false prophets will arise and lead many astray. 12And because wickedness is multiplied, most men's love will grow cold. 13But he who endures to the end will be saved. 14And this gospel of the kingdom will be preached

throughout the whole world, as a testimony to all nations; and then the end will come.

The Desolating Sacrilege

15 “So when you see the desolating sacrilege spoken of by the prophet
Daniel, standing in the holy place (let the reader understand), 16then let
those who are in Judea flee to the mountains; 17let him who is on the
housetop not go down to take what is in his house; 18and let him who is in
the field not turn back to get a coat. 19And alas for those who are with child
and for those who are nursing in those days! 20Pray that your flight may not
be in winter or on a sabbath. 21For then there will be great tribulation, such
as has not been from the beginning of the world until now, no, and never
will be. 22And if those days had not been shortened, no human being would
be saved; but for the sake of the elect those days will be shortened. 23Then
if any one says to you, ‘Behold, here is the Christ!’ or ‘There he is!’ do not
believe it. 24For false Christs and false prophets will arise and show great
signs and wonders, so as to lead astray, if possible, even the elect. 25Behold,
I have told you beforehand. 26So, if they say to you, ‘Behold, he is in the
wilderness,’ do not go out; if they say, ‘Behold, he is in the inner rooms,’ do
not believe it. 27For as the lightning comes from the east and shines as far as
the west, so will be the coming of the Son of man. 28Wherever the body is,
there the eagles [z] will be gathered together.

The Coming of the Son of Man

29 “Immediately after the tribulation of those days the sun will be
darkened, and the moon will not give its light, and the stars will fall from
heaven, and the powers of the heavens will be shaken; 30then will appear
the sign of the Son of man in heaven, and then all the tribes of the earth will
mourn, and they will see the Son of man coming on the clouds of heaven
with power and great glory; 31and he will send out his angels with a loud
trumpet call, and they will gather his elect from the four winds, from one
end of heaven to the other.

The Lesson of the Fig Tree

32 “From the fig tree learn its lesson: as soon as its branch becomes tender
and puts forth its leaves, you know that summer is near. 33So also, when
you see all these things, you know that he is near, at the very gates. 34Truly,

I say to you, this generation will not pass away till all these things take
place. [35]Heaven and earth will pass away, but my words will not pass away.

The Necessity for Watchfulness

36 “But of that day and hour no one knows, not even the angels of heaven,
nor the Son, [a] but the Father only. [37]As were the days of Noah, so will be
the coming of the Son of man. [38]For as in those days before the flood they
were eating and drinking, marrying and giving in marriage, until the day
when Noah entered the ark, [39]and they did not know until the flood came
and swept them all away, so will be the coming of the Son of man. [40]Then
two men will be in the field; one is taken and one is left. [41]Two women will
be grinding at the mill; one is taken and one is left. [42]Watch therefore, for
you do not know on what day your Lord is coming. [43]But know this, that if
the householder had known in what part of the night the thief was coming,
he would have watched and would not have let his house be broken into.
[44]Therefore you also must be ready; for the Son of man is coming at an
hour you do not expect.

The Faithful and the Unfaithful Servant

45 “Who then is the faithful and wise servant, whom his master has set
over his household, to give them their food at the proper time? [46]Blessed is
that servant whom his master when he comes will find so doing. [47]Truly, I
say to you, he will set him over all his possessions. [48]But if that wicked
servant says to himself, ‘My master is delayed,’ [49]and begins to beat his
fellow servants, and eats and drinks with the drunken, [50]the master of that
servant will come on a day when he does not expect him and at an hour he
does not know, [51]and will punish [b] him, and put him with the hypocrites;
there men will weep and gnash their teeth.

The Parable of the Wise and Foolish Maidens

25 “Then the kingdom of heaven shall becompared to ten maidens who
took their lamps and went to meet the bridegroom. [c] [2]Five of them were
foolish, and five were wise. [3]For when the foolish took their lamps, they
took no oil with them; [4]but the wise took flasks of oil with their lamps. [5]As
the bridegroom was delayed, they all slumbered and slept. [6]But at midnight
there was a cry, ‘Behold, the bridegroom! Come out to meet him.’ [7]Then all
those maidens rose and trimmed their lamps. [8]And the foolish said to the
wise, ‘Give us some of your oil, for our lamps are going out.’ [9]But the wise

replied, ‘Perhaps there will not be enough for us and for you; go rather to the dealers and buy for yourselves.’ 10And while they went to buy, the bridegroom came, and those who were ready went in with him to the marriage feast; and the door was shut. 11Afterward the other maidens came also, saying, ‘Lord, lord, open to us.’ 12But he replied, ‘Truly, I say to you, I do not know you.’ 13Watch therefore, for you know neither the day nor the hour.

The Parable of the Talents

14 “For it will be as when a man going on a journey called his servants and entrusted to them his property; 15to one he gave five talents, [d] to another two, to another one, to each according to his ability. Then he went away. 16He who had received the five talents went at once and traded with them; and he made five talents more. 17So also, he who had the two talents made two talents more. 18But he who had received the one talent went and dug in the ground and hid his master’s money. 19Now after a long time the master of those servants came and settled accounts with them. 20And he who had received the five talents came forward, bringing five talents more, saying, ‘Master, you delivered to me five talents; here I have made five talents more.’ 21His master said to him, ‘Well done, good and faithful servant; you have been faithful over a little, I will set you over much; enter into the joy of your master.’ 22And he also who had the two talents came forward, saying, ‘Master, you delivered to me two talents; here I have made two talents more.’ 23His master said to him, ‘Well done, good and faithful servant; you have been faithful over a little, I will set you over much; enter into the joy of your master.’ 24He also who had received the one talent came forward, saying, ‘Master, I knew you to be a hard man, reaping where you did not sow, and gathering where you did not winnow; 25so I was afraid, and I went and hid your talent in the ground. Here you have what is yours.’ 26But his master answered him, ‘You wicked and slothful servant! You knew that I reap where I have not sowed, and gather where I have not winnowed? 27Then you ought to have invested my money with the bankers, and at my coming I should have received what was my own with interest. 28So take the talent from him, and give it to him who has the ten talents. 29For to every one who has will more be given, and he will have abundance; but from him who has not, even what he has will be taken

away. * 30And cast the worthless servant into the outer darkness, where there will be weeping and gnashing of teeth.’

The Judgment of the Nations

31 “When the Son of man comes in his glory, and all the angels with him, then he will sit on his glorious throne. 32Before him will be gathered all the nations, and he will separate them one from another as a shepherd separates the sheep from the goats, 33and he will place the sheep at his right hand, but the goats at the left. 34Then the King will say to those at his right hand, ‘Come, O blessed of my Father, inherit the kingdom prepared for you from the foundation of the world; 35for I was hungry and you gave me food, I was thirsty and you gave me drink, I was a stranger and you welcomed me, 36I was naked and you clothed me, I was sick and you visited me, I was in prison and you came to me.’ 37Then the righteous will answer him, ‘Lord, when did we see you hungry and feed you, or thirsty and give you drink? 38And when did we see you a stranger and welcome you, or naked and clothe you? 39And when did we see you sick or in prison and visit you?’ 40And the King will answer them, ‘Truly, I say to you, as you did it to one of the least of these my brethren, you did it to me.’ 41Then he will say to those at his left hand, ‘Depart from me, you cursed, into the eternal fire prepared for the devil and his angels; 42for I was hungry and you gave me no food, I was thirsty and you gave me no drink, 43I was a stranger and you did not welcome me, naked and you did not clothe me, sick and in prison and you did not visit me.’ 44Then they also will answer, ‘Lord, when did we see you hungry or thirsty or a stranger or naked or sick or in prison, and did not minister to you?’ 45Then he will answer them, ‘Truly, I say to you, as you did it not to one of the least of these, you did it not to me.’ 46And they will go away into eternal punishment, but the righteous into eternal life.”

The Conspiracy to Kill Jesus

26 When Jesus had finished all these sayings, he said to his disciples, 2“You know that after two days the Passover is coming, and the Son of man will be delivered up to be crucified.”

3 Then the chief priests and the elders of the people gathered in the palace of the high priest, who was called Cai'aphas, 4and took counsel together in order to arrest Jesus by stealth and kill him. 5But they said, “Not during the feast, lest there be a tumult among the people.”

The Anointing at Bethany

6 Now when Jesus was at Beth'any in the house of Simon the leper, 7a
woman came up to him with an alabaster jar of very expensive ointment,
and she poured it on his head, as he sat at table. 8But when the disciples saw
it, they were indignant, saying, “Why this waste? 9For this ointment might
have been sold for a large sum, and given to the poor.” 10But Jesus, aware
of this, said to them, “Why do you trouble the woman? For she has done a
beautiful thing to me. 11For you always have the poor with you, but you
will not always have me. 12In pouring this ointment on my body she has
done it to prepare me for burial. 13Truly, I say to you, wherever this gospel
is preached in the whole world, what she has done will be told in memory
of her.”

Judas Agrees to Betray Jesus

14 Then one of the Twelve, who was called Judas Iscariot, went to the
chief priests 15and said, “What will you give me if I deliver him to you?”
And they paid him thirty pieces of silver. 16And from that moment he
sought an opportunity to betray him.

The Passover with the Disciples

17 Now on the first day of Unleavened Bread the disciples came to Jesus,
saying, “Where will you have us prepare for you to eat the Passover?” *
18He said, “Go into the city to such a one, and say to him, ‘The Teacher
says, My time is at hand; I will keep the Passover at your house with my
disciples.' " 19And the disciples did as Jesus had directed them, and they
prepared the Passover.

20 When it was evening, he sat at table with the twelve disciples; e 21and
as they were eating, he said, “Truly, I say to you, one of you will betray
me.” 22And they were very sorrowful, and began to say to him one after
another, “Is it I, Lord?” 23He answered, “He who has dipped his hand in the
dish with me, will betray me. 24The Son of man goes as it is written of him,
but woe to that man by whom the Son of man is betrayed! It would have
been better for that man if he had not been born.” 25Judas, who betrayed
him, said, “Is it I, Master?” f He said to him, “You have said so.”

The Institution of the Last Supper

26 Now as they were eating, * Jesus took bread, and blessed, and broke it,
and gave it to the disciples and said, “Take, eat; this is my body.” 27And he
took a chalice, and when he had given thanks he gave it to them, saying,

“Drink of it, all of you; [28]for this is my blood of the [g] covenant, which is poured out for many for the forgiveness of sins. [29]I tell you I shall not drink again of this fruit of the vine until that day when I drink it new with you in my Father’s kingdom.”

Peter’s Denial Foretold

[30] And when they had sung a hymn, they went out to the Mount of Olives. [31]Then Jesus said to them, “You will all fall away because of me this night; for it is written, ‘I will strike the shepherd, and the sheep of the flock will be scattered.’ [32]But after I am raised up, I will go before you to Galilee.” [33]Peter declared to him, “Though they all fall away because of you, I will never fall away.” [34]Jesus said to him, “Truly, I say to you, this very night, before the cock crows, you will deny me three times.” [35]Peter said to him, “Even if I must die with you, I will not deny you.” And so said all the disciples.

Jesus Prays in Gethsemane

[36] Then Jesus went with them to a place called Gethsem'ane, and he said to his disciples, “Sit here, while I go over there and pray.” [37]And taking with him Peter and the two sons of Zeb'edee, he began to be sorrowful and troubled. [38]Then he said to them, “My soul is very sorrowful, even to death; remain here, and watch [h] with me.” [39]And going a little farther he fell on his face and prayed, “My Father, if it be possible, let this chalice pass from me; nevertheless, not as I will, but as you will.” [40]And he came to the disciples and found them sleeping; and he said to Peter, “So, could you not watch [h] with me one hour? [41]Watch [h] and pray that you may not enter into temptation; the spirit indeed is willing, but the flesh is weak.” [42]Again, for the second time, he went away and prayed, “My Father, if this cannot pass unless I drink it, your will be done.” [43]And again he came and found them sleeping, for their eyes were heavy. [44]So, leaving them again, he went away and prayed for the third time, saying the same words. [45]Then he came to the disciples and said to them, “Are you still sleeping and taking your rest? Behold, the hour is at hand, and the Son of man is betrayed into the hands of sinners. [46]Rise, let us be going; see, my betrayer is at hand.”

The Betrayal and Arrest of Jesus

[47] While he was still speaking, Judas came, one of the Twelve, and with him a great crowd with swords and clubs, from the chief priests and the

elders of the people. 48Now the betrayer had given them a sign, saying, “The one I shall kiss is the man; seize him.” 49And he came up to Jesus at once and said, “Hail, Master!” [i] And he kissed him. 50Jesus said to him, “Friend, why are you here?” [j] Then they came up and laid hands on Jesus and seized him. 51And behold, one of those who were with Jesus stretched out his hand and drew his sword, and struck the slave of the high priest, and cut off his ear. * 52Then Jesus said to him, “Put your sword back into its place; for all who take the sword will perish by the sword. 53Do you think that I cannot appeal to my Father, and he will at once send me more than twelve legions of angels? 54But how then should the Scriptures be fulfilled, that it must be so?” 55At that hour Jesus said to the crowds, “Have you come out as against a robber, with swords and clubs to capture me? Day after day I sat in the temple teaching, and you did not seize me. 56But all this has taken place, that the Scriptures of the prophets might be fulfilled.” Then all the disciples deserted him and fled.

Jesus before the High Priest

57 Then those who had seized Jesus led him to Cai'aphas the high priest, where the scribes and the elders had gathered. 58But Peter followed him at a distance, as far as the courtyard of the high priest, and going inside he sat with the guards to see the end. 59Now the chief priests and the whole council sought false testimony against Jesus that they might put him to death, * 60but they found none, though many false witnesses came forward. At last two came forward 61and said, “This fellow said, ‘I am able to destroy the temple of God, and to build it in three days.' " 62And the high priest stood up and said, “Have you no answer to make? What is it that these men testify against you?” 63But Jesus was silent. And the high priest said to him, “I adjure you by the living God, tell us if you are the Christ, the Son of God.” * 64Jesus said to him, “You have said so. But I tell you, hereafter you will see the Son of man seated at the right hand of Power, and coming on the clouds of heaven.” 65Then the high priest tore his robes, and said, “He has uttered blasphemy. Why do we still need witnesses? You have now heard his blasphemy. 66What is your judgment?” They answered, “He deserves death.” 67Then they spat in his face, and struck him; and some slapped him, 68saying, “Prophesy to us, you Christ! Who is it that struck you?”

Peter Denies Jesus

69 Now Peter was sitting outside in the courtyard. And a maid came up to
him, and said, “You also were with Jesus the Galilean.” **70**But he denied it
before them all, saying, “I do not know what you mean.” **71**And when he
went out to the porch, another maid saw him, and she said to the bystanders,
“This man was with Jesus of Nazareth.” **72**And again he denied it with an
oath, “I do not know the man.” **73**After a little while the bystanders came up
and said to Peter, “Certainly you are also one of them, for your accent
betrays you.” **74**Then he began to invoke a curse on himself and to swear, “I
do not know the man.” And immediately the cock crowed. **75**And Peter
remembered the saying of Jesus, “Before the cock crows, you will deny me
three times.” And he went out and wept bitterly.

Jesus Brought before Pilate

27 When morning came, all the chief priests and the elders of the
people took counsel against Jesus to put him to death; **2**and they bound him
and led him away and delivered him to Pilate the governor.

Judas Hangs Himself

3 When Judas, his betrayer, saw that he was condemned, he repented and
brought back the thirty pieces of silver to the chief priests and the elders,
4saying, “I have sinned in betraying innocent blood.” They said, “What is
that to us? See to it yourself.” **5**And throwing down the pieces of silver in
the temple, he departed; and he went and hanged himself. **6**But the chief
priests, taking the pieces of silver, said, “It is not lawful to put them into the
treasury, since they are blood money.” **7**So they took counsel, and bought
with them the potter’s field, to bury strangers in. **8**Therefore that field has
been called the Field of Blood to this day. **9**Then was fulfilled what had
been spoken by the prophet Jeremiah, saying, “And they took the thirty
pieces of silver, the price of him on whom a price had been set by some of
the sons of Israel, **10**and they gave them for the potter’s field, as the Lord
directed me.”

Pilate Questions Jesus

11 Now Jesus stood before the governor; and the governor asked him,
“Are you the King of the Jews?” Jesus said to him, “You have said so.”
12But when he was accused by the chief priests and elders, he made no
answer. **13**Then Pilate said to him, “Do you not hear how many things they

testify against you?” [14]But he gave him no answer, not even to a single charge; so that the governor wondered greatly.

Barabbas or Jesus?

15 Now at the feast the governor was accustomed to release for the crowd any one prisoner whom they wanted. **16**And they had then a notorious prisoner, called Barab'bas. [k] **17**So when they had gathered, Pilate said to them, “Whom do you want me to release for you, Barab'bas [k] or Jesus who is called Christ?” **18**For he knew that it was out of envy that they had delivered him up. [19]Besides, while he was sitting on the judgment seat, his wife sent word to him, “Have nothing to do with that righteous man, for I have suffered much over him today in a dream.” **20**Now the chief priests and the elders persuaded the people to ask for Barab'bas and destroy Jesus. [21]The governor again said to them, “Which of the two do you want me to release for you?” And they said, “Barab'bas.” **22**Pilate said to them, “Then what shall I do with Jesus who is called Christ?” They all said, “Let him be crucified.” **23**And he said, “Why, what evil has he done?” But they shouted all the more, “Let him be crucified.”

Pilate Delivers Jesus to Be Crucified

[24] So when Pilate saw that he was gaining nothing, but rather that a riot was beginning, he took water and washed his hands before the crowd, saying, “I am innocent of this righteous man’s blood; [l] see to it yourselves.” [25]And all the people answered, “His blood be on us and on our children!” **26**Then he released for them Barab'bas, and having scourged Jesus, delivered him to be crucified.

The Soldiers Mock Jesus

[27] Then the soldiers of the governor took Jesus into the praetorium, and they gathered the whole battalion before him. **28**And they stripped him and put a scarlet robe upon him, **29**and plaiting a crown of thorns they put it on his head, and put a reed in his right hand. And kneeling before him they mocked him, saying, “Hail, King of the Jews!” **30**And they spat upon him, and took the reed and struck him on the head. **31**And when they had mocked him, they stripped him of the robe, and put his own clothes on him, and led him away to crucify him.

The Crucifixion of Jesus

[32] As they were marching out, they came upon a man of Cyre'ne, Simon by name; this man they compelled to carry his cross. [33]And when they came

to a place called Gol'gotha (which means the place of a skull), [34]they offered him wine to drink, mingled with gall; but when he tasted it, he would not drink it. [35]And when they had crucified him, they divided his garments among them by casting lots; [36]then they sat down and kept watch over him there. [37]And over his head they put the charge against him, which read, “This is Jesus the King of the Jews.” [38]Then two robbers were crucified with him, one on the right and one on the left. [39]And those who passed by derided him, wagging their heads [40]and saying, “You who would destroy the temple and build it in three days, save yourself! If you are the Son of God, come down from the cross.” [41]So also the chief priests, with the scribes and elders, mocked him, saying, [42]“He saved others; he cannot save himself. He is the King of Israel; let him come down now from the cross, and we will believe in him. [43]He trusts in God; let God deliver him now, if he desires him; for he said, ‘I am the Son of God.' " [44]And the robbers who were crucified with him also reviled him in the same way.

The Death of Jesus

45 Now from the sixth hour there was darkness over all the land [m] until the ninth hour. [46]And about the ninth hour Jesus cried with a loud voice, “Eli, Eli, la'ma sabach'-tha'ni?” that is, “My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?” * [47]And some of the bystanders hearing it said, “This man is calling Eli'jah.” [48]And one of them at once ran and took a sponge, filled it with vinegar, and put it on a reed, and gave it to him to drink. [49]But the others said, “Wait, let us see whether Eli'jah will come to save him.” [n] [50]And Jesus cried again with a loud voice and yielded up his spirit.

51 And behold, the curtain of the temple was torn in two, from top to bottom; and the earth shook, and the rocks were split; [52]the tombs also were opened, and many bodies of the saints who had fallen asleep were raised, [53]and coming out of the tombs after his resurrection they went into the holy city and appeared to many. [54]When the centurion and those who were with him, keeping watch over Jesus, saw the earthquake and what took place, they were filled with awe, and said, “Truly this was the Son [x] of God!”

55 There were also many women there, looking on from afar, who had followed Jesus from Galilee, ministering to him; [56]among whom were Mary Mag'dalene, and Mary the mother of James and Joseph, and the mother of the sons of Zeb'edee.

The Burial of Jesus

57 When it was evening, there came a rich man from Arimathe'a, named
Joseph, who also was a disciple of Jesus. 58He went to Pilate and asked for
the body of Jesus. Then Pilate ordered it to be given to him. 59And Joseph
took the body, and wrapped it in a clean linen shroud, 60and laid it in his
own new tomb, which he had hewn in the rock; and he rolled a great stone
to the door of the tomb, and departed. 61Mary Mag'dalene and the other
Mary were there, sitting opposite the tomb.

The Guard at the Tomb

62 Next day, that is, after the day of Preparation, the chief priests and the
Pharisees gathered before Pilate 63and said, "Sir, we remember how that
impostor said, while he was still alive, 'After three days I will rise again.'
64Therefore order the tomb to be made secure until the third day, lest his
disciples go and steal him away, and tell the people, 'He has risen from the
dead,' and the last fraud will be worse than the first." 65Pilate said to them,
"You have a guard [o] of soldiers; go, make it as secure as you can." [p] 66So
they went and made the tomb secure by sealing the stone and setting a
guard. *

The Resurrection of Jesus

28 * Now after the sabbath, toward the dawn of the first day of the
week, Mary Mag'dalene and the other Mary went to see the tomb. 2And
behold, there was a great earthquake; for an angel of the Lord descended
from heaven and came and rolled back the stone, and sat upon it. 3His
appearance was like lightning, and his clothing white as snow. 4And for fear
of him the guards trembled and became like dead men. 5But the angel said
to the women, "Do not be afraid; for I know that you seek Jesus who was
crucified. 6He is not here; for he has risen, as he said. Come, see the place
where he [q] lay. 7Then go quickly and tell his disciples that he has risen from
the dead, and behold, he is going before you to Galilee; there you will see
him. Behold, I have told you." 8So they departed quickly from the tomb
with fear and great joy, and ran to tell his disciples. 9And behold, Jesus met
them and said, "Hail!" And they came up and took hold of his feet and
worshiped him. 10Then Jesus said to them, "Do not be afraid; go and tell my
brethren to go to Galilee, and there they will see me."

The Report of the Guard

11 While they were going, behold, some of the guard went into the city
and told the chief priests all that had taken place. 12And when they had
assembled with the elders and taken counsel, they gave a sum of money to
the soldiers 13and said, “Tell people, ‘His disciples came by night and stole
him away while we were asleep.’ 14And if this comes to the governor’s
ears, we will satisfy him and keep you out of trouble.” 15So they took the
money and did as they were directed; and this story has been spread among
the Jews to this day.

Jesus Commissions the Disciples

16 Now the eleven disciples went to Galilee, to the mountain to which
Jesus had directed them. 17And when they saw him they worshiped him; but
some doubted. 18And Jesus came and said to them, “All authority in heaven
and on earth has been given to me. 19Go therefore and make disciples of all
nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the
Holy Spirit, 20teaching them to observe all that I have commanded you; and
behold, I am with you always, to the close of the age.”